

A

AB; able-bodied seaman

abandon; to leave

abdominal; having to do with stomach area

abeam; position on either side of a ship, at right angles to the length of a vessel

abnormal; not normal

abroad; in a foreign country

absolute humidity; the mass of water vapour present in a unit volume of moist air

abyssal depth; at the bottom or deepest part of the ocean

access; the act of entering or approaching e.g. a port

accident; an unintended event involving fatality, injury, ship loss or damage, other property loss or environmental damage

accident at sea; unexpected event that causes damage, injury or death

accommodation; place for crew and passengers in cabins

accommodation ladder; a ladder attached to platform at vessel's side with flat steps and handrails for persons to embark and disembark, also: gangway

accomplish; to complete, to succeed in doing something

account; a statement of monetary transactions

acid rain; rain full of harmful chemicals

actuate; to put into action or motion, to make something operate

actuator; a motor providing some motion

adjacent; next to

adjustable; being able to suit, adaptable

adrift; floating without a clearly determinable direction, esp. of a vessel at sea without power

adverse weather; unfavourable weather conditions

afloat; floating on the surface of the water

A-frame; a structural element of an engine in the form of the letter A, also: engine bed

aft; at, near or towards the stern

ahead; in front of something or somebody, esp. with reference to own ship

air compressor; a machine for increasing pressure of air in order to condense it

air conditioning compressor; a mechanical device which controls the coolant of air condition unit

air pollution; a substance in the air, that is harmful to humans and the environment

air starting valve; a valve that admits compressed air to the air starter

air-fuel ratio; the ratio (by weight and volume) between air and fuel

algae; small and simple plants in or near the water

alignment; an arrangement in a straight line

alleged; so-called, declared but without proof, presumed

allowance; 1. an amount of something that you are allowed to do 2. an amount of money that you or your family members get 3. DSA – daily subsistence allowance, money allowed daily to a person for food and other expenses

alloy; a substance that is a mixture of two or more metals

alongside; along the quay, along the ship's side

amenity; a structure, such as a swimming pool or shopping centre, that is intended to make life more pleasant or comfortable for the people in a town, hotel or other place (plural: amenities)

amidships; in the middle part of the ship

anchor; a heavy piece of ship's equipment, usually of cast iron, attached to a vessel's bow by a chain and dropped overboard so as to keep a boat or ship in place

anchor dragging; moving of an anchor over the sea bottom involuntarily because it is no longer preventing the movement of the vessel

anchorage; a place allocated by the authorities for ships to anchor

angle; the difference in direction between two straight lines or surfaces meeting in one point, commonly measured in degrees or radians

anti-clockwise; in the opposite direction to the movement of the hand of the clock or watch

anti-fouling; protection of the ship's hull by using chemicals or other cleaning methods

approximately; about, roughly, close to

arresting gear; a device used to hold a hook-equipped aircraft in a routine or emergency landing

asphalt; a black sticky substance mixed with sand or small stones to form a strong surface when it hardens

assembly; parts fitted together to make a whole

assembly station; a place on deck or in messrooms assigned to crew and passengers where they have to meet according to the muster list when the corresponding alarm is released

astern; towards the stern, at the stern of the ship

astern of; behind the ship

asthma; a respiratory disorder, often of allergic origin

atmospheric; relating to the atmosphere or the air

auspices; state when a larger organization accepts and manages responsibility on behalf of smaller

Automatic Identification System; a system used by ships and Vessel Traffic Services for identification and locating vessels

automotive; having to do with cars or motor vehicles

auxiliary; helping, supporting, ancillary

auxiliary boiler; a boiler which maintains steam pressure when the engine is in standby mode

auxiliary engine; the engine used for manoeuvring purposes and when the main engine breaks down

average; normal, ordinary, medium in value, arithmetic mean

awareness; the ability to perceive, feel or be conscious of events

axial; axis of the Earth, the line round which the Earth rotates

axial force; (of propellers) force acting along the ship's fore and aft line and pushing the ship ahead, also: axial thrust

axial thrust; see: axial force

B

backing wind; the wind which blows round by changing direction in an anticlockwise manner

bag; sack made of paper, cloth or plastic capable of being closed at the mouth

bale capacity; space available for the stowage of baled cargo in ship's holds, measured in cubic feet

ballast; heavy matter such as sand, stone or water that is used at the bottom of a ship to make it heavier and improve the stability

ban; to forbid, especially officially

bareboat charter; a contract for the hire of a vessel only, without crew, stores, fuel and the like, also: charter by demise

barge; a flat-bottomed vessel, usually intended to be towed or pushed, for transporting cargo or passengers, also: lighter

barge carrier; a vessel which usually carries lighters or flat bottomed barges on board

barnacle; a small sea creature with a shell that sticks very tightly and in large numbers to rocks and the bottom of boats

barometer; an instrument used to measure atmospheric pressure

barrel; 1. a large, cylindrical, wooden container with flat, circular ends 2. a unit of capacity used in the oil and other industries, normally equal to 42 U.S. gallons or 35 Imperial gallons 3. drum (of a windlass or winch)

- beacon**; a guiding or warning signal such as a light or fire in elevated position, a lighthouse on a shore or a signal buoy at a dangerous area at sea to warn or guide vessels
- beacon buoy**; a seamark with a spar and a light
- beam**; 1. the maximum breadth of a ship 2. a steel girder across the ship carrying the deck 3. ship's side (on the port/starboard beam)
- bearing**; 1. direction relative to one's own position or to the compass 2. (in marine engineering) a support, guide, or locating piece for a rotating shaft or axle
- bend**; 1. to force an object into a curved line 2. (of a line) to attach or fasten a line to a cleat, bitt or another line
- benthos**; the organisms which live on, in, or near the seabed, also known as the benthic zone deposit
- berth**; 1. a place for securing a vessel (for conducting commercial operations) 2. a bed in a passenger cabin 3. distance (give this object a wide berth means keep well clear of)
- bilge**; 1. almost flat part of the ship's bottom into which dirty water drains from the cargo holds 2. the widest part of a barrel
- bilge pump**; a device for pumping dirty water from the bilges
- bill of lading**; a document stating that goods have been shipped on board and are to be delivered to a consignee at a port of destination, also: B/L
- biochemistry**; the scientific study of the chemistry of living things
- bite, bit, bitten**; (of an anchor) to hold the ground
- bitt**; 1. a bollard, a pair of strong posts of iron projecting above the deck of a ship, used for securing cables, lines for towing etc. 2. (on shore) a strong metal post mounted on a wharf, quay, etc., used for securing mooring lines
- B/L**; see: bill of lading
- blade**; the arm of a propeller or other similar turning mechanism such as an electric fan or turbine
- blank**; to cover over
- blank bill of lading**; bill of lading to the bearer of the document
- blank flange**; a flange which covers the open end of the pipe
- blast**; a sound of the ship's siren or whistle
- blast of wind**; a strong gust of wind
- blind sector**; an area which cannot be scanned by the ship's radar because it is hidden by parts of its superstructure or shore obstructions, a sector which cannot be seen
- blizzard**; snow storm
- blower**; a device for increasing the weight of air supplied to a cylinder, driven mechanically, electrically or by exhaust gas turbine
- blue water**; open ocean
- boarding arrangements**; all equipment, such as pilot ladder, accommodation ladder, hoist, etc. necessary for safe transfer of the pilot
- boarding speed**; mutually agreed speed of a vessel for pilot to embark
- boiler**; a tank, in which water is turned to steam for heating
- bollard**; a strong post on the quay for mooring, also on ship's deck
- bolt**; a piece of metal used with a nut to hold two things together
- booster pump**; a pump used to increase pressure in a liquid line, or to pull liquid from a tank and pressurize a system
- bore**; 1. to make a hole in or through, with a drill or an engine cylinder diameter 2. the width of a cylinder
- bottom dead centre**; the exact bottom of the piston stroke in a reciprocating engine or pump
- bottom-dwelling**; to dwell attached to or close to the bottom
- bow**; the fore part of the ship, forward end of the ship
- bow thruster**; a device which assists ship handling by moving the bow or stern laterally

box; a container, case or receptacle

brackish water; slightly briny or salty water

branch line; a pipe of smaller size connected to the main line

brash ice; floating bits of sea ice or river ice

break bulk carrier; see: break bulk vessel

break bulk vessel; a ship which carries packaged goods, usually manufactured, for individual consignees and has to be loaded and unloaded piece by piece at each port of transfer, formerly referred to as general cargo or piece goods, also: break bulk carrier

breakdown; 1. (of an engine) failure to function 2. (in statistics) division into sections or parts

bridge; the place from which a ship is steered

broken stowage; the empty space which is not taken up by the cargo (usually not chargeable and therefore useless)

broker; an agent or intermediary, acting on behalf of a principal, who buys or sells goods, securities, etc., in return for a commission

brokerage; fee or commission payable by a shipowner to a shipbroker for the successful negotiation of a charter

brown water; the littoral areas, from the coast and estuarial areas to perhaps a hundred miles from shore. It is the most important maritime arena, including all coastal traffic and territorial waters, in which are found the great majority of a nation's maritime police, customs, environmental, and economic concerns.

bucket; 1. a deep, round container with a flat bottom and a curved handle, used to carry water, coal, ores and other bulk cargoes (e.g. a bucket wheel loader/unloader) 2. pail, a deep cylindrical vessel with a flat bottom for holding or carrying water, a bailer

bulb; the very front bulb-like part of a bow below waterline intended to reduce a vessel's resistance to motion

bulk cargo; unpacked, loose cargo carried in large quantities, e.g. iron ore, coal, grain, etc.

bulk carrier; a single-deck ship designed to carry dry cargoes such as grain or coal in bulk, also: bulker

bulk chemicals; chemicals transported in bulk (i.e. loose) and not in packages or containers

bulker; see: bulk carrier

bulkhead; a wall-like transverse structure inside the vessel forming watertight compartments

bundle; several objects or pieces bound together, e.g. goat skins in bundles

bunkering; supplying a ship with fuel

buoy; a floating device used as an aid to navigation

buoyage; a system of marking the fairways and roads with buoys

burner; the principal device for the firing of oil and/or gas

burns and scalds; damage to a skin after burning oneself

bushing; a renewable lining for a hole in which a shaft, rod, or similar part moves

byelaw; see: by-law

by-law; local rules and regulations, usually national, regional or municipal, or referring to a port authority, company rules and regulations

C

cable; 1. 1/10 of a nautical mile 2. wire or chain connecting a vessel to her anchor 3. a thick line, hawser

cable buoy; a floating object marking the position of underwater cables

call at; to enter a port, usually for a brief period (for example to collect supplies or fuel)

Calling-In-Point; a point at which a vessel has to report

call sign; letters in combination with numbers used for identifying the vessel

calm sea; the sea like a mirror, Beaufort Scale 0

cam; projecting part of a rotating wheel or shaft

cam follower; a lifter

camshaft; a shaft which carries various cams required for the operation of inlet, exhaust and fuel valves

can buoy; a cylindrical unlighted buoy used as a channel marker

cap; an internally threaded cup-shaped part that screws on, a fitting that closes an end

capacity; the ability to receive, contain or lift (a cargo or load)

capitalize; to write with a capital letter

capsize; (of ships) to turn upside down at sea

capstan; a windlass rotated around a horizontal plane by hand or machinery for winding in ropes and cables

capture; (in marine insurance) the act of taking by force, seizure (e.g. a ship at a port)

carbondioxide; a gas at standard temperature produced during respiration by plants animals etc. that depend directly or indirectly on plants for food. It can also be generated as a by-product from combustion of fossil fuels.

carcinogenic; any substance which is an agent directly involved in the promotion or increased propagation of cancer

cardinal buoy; see: cardinal mark

cardinal mark; a pillar-shaped or spar-shaped buoy with different topmarks indicating the North, South, East and West from a fixed point e.g. a wreck, shallow water, banks etc., also: cardinal buoy

cargo; commodities or goods to be loaded on board ship, load, goods and products carried in a vessel

cargo arm; a rigid part of cargo gear connecting the ship's manifolds and the tanks and pipes ashore

cargo capacity; the entire capacity available for cargo on board ship

cargo control room; a room on board a ship from which the valves on board the ship may be operated automatically or tank contents monitored remotely

cargo hose; a flexible part of cargo gear connecting the ship's manifolds and the tanks and pipes ashore

cargo operation; a manual or mechanical process by which cargo is moved in port

cargo space; the entire space available for cargo on board ship, e.g. on board Ro-Ro or Con-RO ships is expressed in the length of lanes and is measured in metres

cargo tank; a part of cargo space on board a ship designed for carrying liquid cargo

carriage; the whole or any part of the operations and services undertaken by the Carrier in respect of the Goods covered by a Bill of Lading, transport of goods by sea

carrier; 1. the party named in the Signature Box on the face of the document 2. a vessel or a company engaged in transporting passengers and goods across the sea for a profit

carrier's remuneration; money in the form of freight for the carriage of goods

CAS; Condition Assessment Scheme (for tankers)

case; 1. a small portable container, a box 2. a case in court

cask; a barrel for carrying liquids

cask buoy; barrel buoy

cast; to throw or hurl, to heave a line across (e.g. from ship to shore)

cast off; to take the line off the bitt or bollard, let go the line

cast anchor; drop the anchor, let go the anchor (SMCP)

casualty; 1. a person injured or killed in an accident or shipping disaster 2. a ship involved in an accident

centre tank; a cargo tank between wing tanks

CES; see: Coast Earth Station

CFR; see: Cost and Freight

changeover; complete change from one thing or condition to another

charge; 1. to require payment for a service (e.g. charge freight) 2. formally accuse 3. charge the battery

chart; sea map

charter; 1. to hire a vessel 2. a charter party contract

charter commission; broker's commission (compensation in percentage for a service)

charterer; the individual or company who hires a ship

chartering broker; a broker dealing with charter parties

charter-party; the contract setting out the terms under which the shipper contracts for the transportation of his cargo or the charterer contracts for the hire of a ship

chartroom; a compartment on or near the bridge for handling and stowage of navigational equipment

chemical; any material with a definite chemical composition

chemical cargo carrier; a ship specially designed to carry chemicals

chemical tanker; a tanker specially designed to carry chemicals

chief engineer; the head of the engine-room department

chief officer; the head of the deck department

chief petty officer; bosun

chief steward; the head of the catering department

chock; 1. a block of wood that can be put under a wheel or heavy cargo to prevent it from moving 2. (Am.) a fairlead

choke; to block or clog up

chute; a vertical or inclined passage, through which something can be dropped

CIF; see: Cost, Insurance and Freight

C.I.P.; see: Calling-In-Point

circuit; 1. a loop, a circular route, a roundabout way 2. a closed system of wires through which electricity flows

claim; a written request to pay for the damage

clarity; quality of being clear or easy to understand

clausd bill of lading; bill of lading having additionally printed restrictive clauses (remarks), (unclean or foul B/L)

clean bill of lading; bill of lading without remarks (unclosed B/L)

cleanups; making a person or place clean and tidy

clearance; 1. the space between a moving and a stationary part 2. a distance between the bottom of the ship and the sea bed 3. the procedure of clearing the ship inward or outward 4. removal

clipper; a fast sailing vessel which was used in the past for carrying tea and spices

clockwise; in the direction in which the hands of a clock rotate

Closest Point of Approach; the shortest passing distance

closing date; a deadline by which the cargo should be on board

clutch; a device for connecting and disconnecting two working parts without bringing them to rest

C/N; credit note

COA; see: contract of affreightment

coal barge; a barge or hopper that carries coal

coal carrier; a vessel specially designed to carry coal, also: collier

Coast Earth Station; a radio station located on the coast, also: CES

Coast Guard; an organisation engaged by the Government (e.g. Ministry of the Interior, Defence, Transport) to watch the sea for ships in danger or involved in illegal activities near the coast

coastal; situated on the coast or relating to the coast (coastal waters)

coaster; a vessel that sails between ports along the coast

coastline; the particular shape of the land along the coast, especially as seen from the sea, the air or on a map

coil; one or more insulated wires wound in a series of turns

coke; coal from which most of the gases have been removed, used as fuel in industry

collapse; to fall down suddenly

collective bill of lading; a bill of lading which includes several consignments

collier; see: coal carrier

collision; an accident in which a ship that is moving crashes into another ship or object, the act of coming together with sudden, violent force

colonisation; the act of colonising (see: colonise)

colonise; micro-organisms that settle on a ship's hull and 'take over'

comb the coasts; to search a place or an area very carefully in order to find something

combat; a purposeful conflict to establish dominance

combination carrier; a bulker designed to carry both dry and liquid bulk cargo

combination tanker; a tanker designed to carry either liquefied petroleum gas or chemicals

combustion; a chemical reaction between a fuel and an oxidant producing heat or both heat and light

combustion chamber; the area in which the combustion reaction can be isolated and confined so that it can be easily controlled. In a scotch marine boiler it is referred to as a Morrison tube. In other boilers it is called a combustion furnace.

commerce; buying and selling of goods, trading business

commercialisation; exploitation for profit esp. at the expense of quality

commission; 1. to put a vessel into service 2. percentual compensation charged by an agent or broker for a service

commodity; 1. an article of commerce, (an item of) cargo, goods, freight 2. something of use, profit or advantage

common rail; fuel injection system with fuel circulating to all injectors all the time

compartment; one of the sections (of a ship) into which an enclosed space is divided

compass; a navigational instrument for determining direction relative to the Earth's magnetic poles

compound; a chemical that combines two or more elements

comprehensive; dealing with all, including much

compression; the process of compressing the air or the state of being compressed

Compression Wave Velocity; measure indicating how fast waves going through a material are compressed

compressor; a mechanical device that compresses the air or other gases

compulsory; obligatory or mandatory

condense; to make more dense or reduce to another denser form

condenser; a chamber where exhaust steam is led to condense into water

confined space; a space that has a limited access, poor or no ventilation, and is not intended for continuous human occupancy, e.g. a ballast tank, a fuel tank

confined waters; narrow or restricted waters making navigation difficult

conical buoy; a seamark in a shape of a cone or having conical topmarks

connecting rod; a rod connecting piston to a crankshaft

conquer; to get control by overcoming some forces, to win

CON-RO; Container and Ro-Ro vessel

consecutive; following in order, successive

consecutive voyage charter; a charter party for the next voyage

consignee; a person or company to whom the cargo or other merchandise is sent, a recipient, receiver of the goods

consignment; goods sent to an agent for sale, storage or shipment, shipment

constant; not changing, invariable

container; a large reusable box for solidating smaller cartons and cases into a single shipment, designed for easy and fast loading and unloading of freight

container port; a port whose only or mainly traffic is cargo in containers

container vessel; a vessel specially designed for the carriage of containers

containerise; to put goods into a container (large standard size box) for transport

containerised cargo; cargo stowed in a container

containment; the process of controlling a substance (or situation) that could become harmful or dangerous

contaminant; a substance that makes another substance impure

contaminate; to introduce a foreign substance or energy exceeding natural levels, to make impure or change characteristics esp. by touching, mixing or stowing nearby

contamination; the presence of unwanted or dangerous substances

contingency; an event that might happen in the future but cannot be definitely predicted, esp. something bad or undesirable

contract; a formal agreement between two or more people, or parties, to do something

contract freight rate; a specified freight rate mentioned in the contract

contract of affreightment; an agreement under which a shipowner undertakes to carry quantities of a specific cargo on a particular route or routes over a given period of time (usually under annual agreements) against a set price per ton using ships of his choice with specific restrictions, also: COA

controllable pitch propeller; a propeller with a pitch (i.e. blade angle) that can be changed at any time, subject to bridge or engine room control

controllable pitch propeller automatic recorder; a device which shows the propeller blade pitch

convey; to transfer, carry

conveyor; a mechanical chain or belt for carrying (usually bulk cargo)

convoy; a group of vessels which sail together e.g. through a canal or ice

cool; to bring to cold temperature

coolant; a substance, usually a fluid, used to remove heat, a cooling agent, in car or other cooling systems also called antifreeze

cooler; a device that cools or keeps cool

cooling; lowering the temperature of cargo

cooling agent; chemical component used in the process of cooling

cooling chamber; cooling compartment

Coordinator of Surface Search; see: on-scene commander

copper; a ductile pink or peach coloured metal with high electrical and thermal conductivity

coral reef; a bank of coral, the top of which can sometimes be seen just above the sea

corporation; 1. a group of people authorized by law to act as an individual and having its own powers, duties, and liabilities 2. the municipal authorities of a city or town 3. a particular type of company

corporatisation; a process by which formerly public assets or functions are sold or given to corporate entities

correction of charts; up-dating of sea charts

corresponding speed; matching speed of e.g. a pilot boat

corrosion; rusting

corrosive; harmful to metal parts of a ship

Cost and Freight; an international trade term (INCOTERMS) indicating that the seller must pay the costs and freight to bring the goods to the port of destination, however, risk is transferred to the buyer once the goods have crossed the ship's rail, also: CFR

cost efficiency; being economic by minimising the difference between cost input and a different output

Cost, Insurance and Freight; an international trade term (INCOTERMS) indicating that the seller must pay the costs and freight to bring the goods to the named port of destination, in addition, the seller must procure and pay for insurance for the buyer, the buyer is responsible for the import customs clearance and other costs and risks, also: CIF

counterclockwise; turning in the direction opposite the clock hands

couple (to); to connect

coupled with; secured together in such a manner as to permit disassembly if necessary

course; the direction taken by a ship

course made good; the course which a vessel makes good over the ground after allowing for the effects of currents, tidal streams and leeway caused by wind and sea

course over the ground; direction of the ship's movement relative to the earth, measured on board the ship, expressed in angular units from true north

COW; see: crude oil washing

c.p.; custom of the port

C/P; see: Charter Party

CPA; see: Closest Point of Approach

C.P.A.; see: Closest Point of Approach

C/P blading; charter party bill of lading

C.P.D.; charterers pay dues

crack; a break, usually without the separation of parts

crane; 1. a device for lifting and moving heavy weights in suspension 2. a number of supports for a boat (e.g. davit)

crank; a lever or bar used to transfer a force to a load and usually to provide a mechanical advantage, e.g. for rotating shaft

crankcase; a part of the main engine consisting mainly of a crankshaft, bearings and a connecting-rod

crank pin; a short cylindrical pin at the outer end of a crank, held by and moving with a connecting rod

crankshaft; a shaft having one or more cranks for transmitting motion

crankshaft throw; one crankpin with its two webs

crate; a large basket or a box, made of pieces of wooden strips or thin battens (for carrying vegetable, fruit etc.)

critical speed; critical revolutions of the engine, critical velocity

cross bearing; fixing the ship's position by taking bearings of two different objects on shore

cross section; cutting through something

crosshead; the lower end of the piston rod, carries the top end of the connecting rod

crossover valve; a valve which separates tanks in port-starboard-port direction

crude oil; a naturally occurring flammable liquid found in rock formations

crude oil tanker; a tanker designed to carry crude oil

crude oil washing; a system of cleaning tanks with crude oil

cruise; a pleasure trip by boat or a passenger ship

cruise ship; a passenger ship used for pleasure trips taking passengers on extended cruises calling occasionally at ports having various places of interest

crushed ice; ice in small pieces

crustacean; a class of animals having a shell or a crust, living in water

CSS; Coordinator of Surface Search

current; a large body of water moving in a certain direction like a stream

curriculum; the group of subjects studied in a school, college, etc.

cushion; a soft pad for absorbing shock

cyclone; a violent tropical storm in which the air moves very fast in a circular direction,

counterclockwise in the Northern Hemisphere and clockwise in the Southern Hemisphere (= depression)

cyclonic wind; a low pressure wind

cylinder; a round geometric figure hollow inside

cylinder block; the metal casting containing the cylinders and cooling channels or fins of a reciprocating internal-combustion engine

cylinder bore; measured in millimeters (mm) or in centimeters (cm) and is used to identify the interior (inside) diameter of the cylinder

cylinder head; a casing bolted to the top of the cylinder block, contains valves and injectors (=cylinder cover)

cylindrical buoy; a seamark having the form of a cylinder

D

damage; 1. to spoil or harm something thus resulting in a loss or an injury that reduces value or usefulness 2. harm or injury that reduces value or usefulness

damp; 1. to reduce noise level 2. (adj) wet, moist

damper; a device for reducing the motion or oscillations of moving parts

dangerous cargo; see: dangerous goods

dangerous goods; goods listed in the IMDG code, hazardous goods

davit; a cranelike device used singly or in pairs for supporting, raising or lowering boats, anchors and cargo over a hatchway or side of a ship

day on demurrage; day beyond the time allowed or agreed upon (in a C/P) spent waiting for cargo and a charge for the time lost

dead freight; an amount of money paid by the contractor who charts space in a ship but fails to fill it fully, freight paid for space booked but not used

dead reckoning; calculating the ship's position on the basis of distance run on various headings since the last precisely observed position, with as accurate allowance as possible being made for wind, currents, compass errors etc.

dead slow ahead; as slow as possible movement forward without losing steerageway

dead slow astern; as slow as possible movement backwards without losing steerageway

deadweight; the difference between the loaded and light displacement tonnage of the vessel

deadweight capacity; the capacity in long tons of cargo, passengers, fuel, stores of a vessel

deadweight cargo capacity; net capacity of the vessel in long tonnes of cargo

debris; broken or torn pieces of something larger

decade; a period of tens years: e.g. 1860–1869 inclusive

deck; the permanent covering over a compartment or hull of a vessel

deck cargo; cargo and goods carried on deck

deck department; a ship's department including officers and ratings responsible for navigation and cargo handling operations

deck hand; a seaman whose duties are performed on deck

deck officer; an officer whose responsibilities include navigation and cargo handling

declination; 1. the arc of the celestial body measured north or south of the equinoctial 2. (in magnetism) magnetic variation

decline; to gradually become less, worse, or lower

decrease; to diminish, to become less

deep draught vessel; a ship with big depth when carrying a heavy load (in COLREGS, a vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre because of her draft)

deep stowage; a place deep in the hold where the cargo is stowed

deep tank; a deep compartment on board ship for the carriage of vegetable oil or lard

defect; fault, shortcoming, deficiency
defective; faulty
deficient; lacking something, inadequate, incomplete
deformation; some change in the shape of a material under load, damage
defrost; thaw, free of ice
defrosting; freeing of ice, thawing
degrade; to cause people to feel that they or other people are worthless and do not have the respect or good opinion of others
delay; postponing, slowing down
delivery; a shipment of goods from the seller to the buyer, handover of the cargo
demand; to ask for, to claim
demijohn; a bottle having a short narrow neck usually encased in wickerwork
demolition market; the market where old or obsolete vessels are sold to scrap dealers
demurrage; compensation paid to the shipowner for delay of a vessel beyond the stipulated time allowed in the charter party for loading and discharging
density; mass of an object to its volume, thickness
departure; leaving the harbour or airport or station
depression; 1. an area of low atmospheric pressure 2. an area lower than the surrounding surface
depth; a vertical measure from the lowest point in the ship's hull, ordinarily from the bottom of the keel, to the side of any deck that may be chosen as a reference point, stated in specific terms such as depth to upper deck amidships
derelict; an abandoned vessel at sea, still afloat
derrick; a large device (on the deck of a ship) for lifting and moving heavy objects
despatch; see: dispatch
dispatch; the money paid to the charterer for loading or discharging the vessel in less time than has been allowed in the charter party, also: despatch
destination; a place to which somebody or something is going or being sent
detect; to discover, to find out
deteriorate; to get worse, to worsen (usually referring to perishable goods)
detrimental; harmful
devastate; to destroy a place or thing completely or cause great damage
deviation; 1. an error of a ship's magnetic compass on a given heading as a result of local magnetism 2. going off the proper course or route, departure from the set or planned course of the voyage
DGPS; Differential Global Positioning System
diameter; a straight line going through a centre of a circle from one side to the other
diesel generator; a device which generates electric current, providing power to units as required
dig out; to get someone or something out of somewhere by digging
digest; to change food in the stomach into substances that the body can use
digestive system; the organs in a human body that digest food
digital; the representation of information in binary form (ones and zeros)
Digital Selective Calling; (in ships carrying a GMDSS unit) a semi-automated method of establishing maritime MF, HF, and VHF radio calls to individual stations, groups of stations, or "all stations" in one's reach, also: DSC
dimension; measurements in length, width and sometimes depth
dipper; a cuplike container with a long handle for dipping liquids
disable; to make unable, unfit, ineffective
disabled ship; unseaworthy vessel, a vessel damaged or impaired in such a way as to be unable to proceed (in COLREGS: NUC = a ship not under command)
discard; to throw something away or get rid of it because it is no longer wanted or needed

discharge; 1. to unload, to land 2. to send or pour out a substance, esp. (waste) liquid or gas

discharging berth; unloading place at the quay

discharging rate; amount of cargo unloaded per hour or per day

disease; an illness of people, animals, plants, etc., caused by infection or a failure of health rather than by an accident

disembark; to go ashore from the ship, land

disembarkation; going ashore from the ship

dish; see: satellite dish

dismantle; to put to pieces, to pull down

dispatch; 1. to send off quickly 2. a payment, by way of a bonus, to the charterer for loading or discharging the vessel in less time than stipulated in the charter party

displacement; the actual weight of the ship measured in tonnes of 2240lbs or in metric tonnes, the amount of water the ship displaces at her load draught

disposal; a process of getting rid of something (e.g. disposal of nuclear waste at sea)

dispose of; to get rid of something

disrupt; to prevent something, esp. a system, process or event, from continuing as usual or as expected

dissolve; to be absorbed (a solid substance) by a liquid, especially when mixed into the liquid and so becomes included in it

distil; to make a liquid stronger or purer

distortion; the process of twisting, changing the shape

distress; the state of extreme, grave and imminent danger to the ship and crew requiring immediate assistance

distress alert; a call based on the use of satellites, terrestrial services or digital selective calling used to alert Rescue Coordination Centres and ships in the vicinity of the ship in distress providing the identification of the ship in distress and its position and having the purpose to begin distress traffic

distress call; a call sent by radiotelephony by the vessel in distress including distress signal MAYDAY spoken three times, the words this is and the name or other identification of the vessel in distress spoken three times

distress frequency; VHF channel 16, a radio frequency band of 2182 kHz or other radio frequency band allocated for distress calls and distress traffic

distress message; a message from the vessel in distress following standard format and giving the following information: distress signal, identification of the vessel in distress, its position, the nature of the distress, the type of assistance required and any other information which might facilitate rescue, such as the number of persons injured

distress signal; an internationally recognized signal sent out by a ship or plane in danger for the purpose of summoning help such as a radio code MAYDAY or SOS, a flare or a flag

diverge; (of courses) to move in different directions away from a common point

dock; 1. to enter the port 2. a port basin 3. a pier or wharf 4. a dry or floating dock in the shipyard

dockyard; a shipyard, naval dock

dolphin; 1. a bollard 2. a sea mammal that looks like a long fish with a pointed mouth 3. a fender

domestic laws; laws relating to a person's own country

donkeyman; a member of crew who is in charge of a donkey (steam) boiler or engine, and assists in the engine room

double bottom; space between the inner and outer bottom plating of hull, the double bottom of a ship is divided into a number of tanks for storing fresh and ballast water and fuel oil

double hull ship; a ship having two hulls, usually a tanker or chemical tanker

downstream; in the direction a river or stream is flowing

downwind; in the same direction in which the wind blows

draft; 1. the depth of water at which a ship floats, also: draught 2. a piece of text, a formal suggestion or a drawing in its original state, often containing the main ideas and intentions but not the developed form

draft fore; draught on the forward part of the ship, on the bow

drag; to pull along the ground

drag on the hull; the force of the water that creates resistance to the ship

dragging of an anchor; pulling an anchor over the sea bottom involuntarily because it is no longer preventing the movement of a ship

dragnet; a heavy net pulled along the sea bottom when searching for something

drain; become dry as the liquid flows off

draught; see: draft

dredge; to deepen the channel

dredge anchor; to pull the anchor under control or to control the movement of a ship

dredge up; to remove unwanted things from the bottom of a river, lake, etc. using a sucking or other device

dredger; a vessel used for deepening a channel or area, hopper

dredging; (of anchor) manoeuvring a vessel by moving the anchor over the sea bottom

dressing; a covering for a wound, sore etc.

drift; 1. to be carried along by current and wind 2. ocean current generated and maintained by constant wind 3. the distance a current flows in a given time (=speed)

drift anchor; sea anchor

drifting; being driven along by the wind, tide or current

drill; 1. to make holes using a drill 2. a tool for boring holes in materials

drip tray; a shallow metal pan placed under a connection or a valve in a pipeline for collecting the dripping water or oil

drizzle; slight gentle and steady rain

drop anchor; let go the anchor

drop line; a pipeline which leads vertically from a deck line to a tank line

drop valve; a valve which controls the flow of the cargo in the drop line

drown; to die under water of suffocation

drowning; dying under water (used about people)

drum; 1. a cylindrical or rounded container for hot water, steam or gas 2. winch drum

dry; free from moisture

dry-bulk carrier; a ship designed for the carriage of dry solids (ores, coal, etc.) in bulk, without packaging

dry (bulk) cargo; cargo stowed in bulk consisting of ores, grain, coal, coke etc.

dry cargo hold; a hold for carrying dry cargo on a tanker

dry cargo ship; a vessel for the carriage of dry cargo such as grain or coal

dry dock; a structure on shore able to receive a ship and to be drained so as to leave the ship free of water with all parts of the hull accessible for repairs, painting

DSC; see: Digital Selective Calling

duct; see: ducting

ducting; a tube, a leading, a canal through which some liquid or gas moves

due to; because of

dual purpose officer; an officer having qualifications for work both on deck and in the engine room (MarOff in the Netherlands)

dump; 1. to throw waste into the sea 2. a place where people are allowed to leave their rubbish

dumping; an act of getting rid of something unwanted, esp. by leaving it in a place where it is not allowed to be

dunnage; loose separation material laid beneath or wedged among objects carried by the ship to prevent damage from chafing or moisture

dust; powdery sand

dwt; deadweight tonnage

E

ear protector; a device protecting ears against noise

earth; to connect with the ground

earthing; an act done to prevent static electricity discharge when connecting or disconnecting cargo hoses

earthing cable; a cable used to earth an object

ease; freedom from difficulty, slack

ease a line; to slacken a rope, to lessen the hold upon the line

ease away; to slacken the sail

ease her; to slow down, reduce the revolutions of the engine

Ease the helm!; an order to bring the helm slowly amidships

eastward; moving towards east

ebb; see: ebb tide

ebb tide; the reflux of the tide, the flowing back of the tide as the water returns to the sea

ECDIS; Electronic Chart Display Information System

echo sounder; an instrument for determining depth of water or locating objects at certain depth

economies of scale; reductions in the cost of making and/or selling products that are made possible because the business is very large or becomes larger

ecosystem; a natural unit consisting of all plants, animals and micro-organisms functioning together in the environment

edge; a brink or verge, e.g. the edge of a cliff

E.D.H.; see: Efficient Deck Hand

Efficient Deck Hand; a senior rating or seaman

EHF; see: extremely high frequency

elasticity; ability of a material to return to its original form and size without permanent deformation

eliminate; to remove or take out

emaciated; very thin and weak, usually because of illness or extreme hunger

embankment; raised dike or quay to hold the waters of the sea or river

embark; to come on board the vessel (referring to passengers, crew and the pilot)

embarkation; going on board the vessel

emergency; a state of sudden and unexpected danger requiring immediate action

emergency alarm; a device for giving a warning in the event of danger to the ship

emergency anchorage; an area of the sea used by ships in dangerous situations, e.g. fire on board

emergency exit; way out in dangerous situations

emergency fire pump; a pump which is used when the main supply fails

emergency fire pump compartment; a room where the emergency fire pump is located

emergency full speed; maximum full speed

emergency plan; 1. a plan in the event of a serious or dangerous accident, which happens suddenly or unexpectedly and needs immediate action 2. the general arrangement plan providing information on items such as escape routes and safety equipment

emergency shutdown; a button or a switch to be used in case of sudden necessity to stop a cargo operation

emergency signal; alarm signal used in dangerous situations

emergency steering gear; steering gear used in case of main steering breakdown

emergency stop; see: emergency shutdown
emergency tiller; a lever fitted to the rudder used in an emergency
emergency towing-off wire; a wire needed in the event of fire or other emergency and used by a tug to move the ship away from the berth
emission; an act or event during which gas, heat, light, etc. is sent out
employ; to offer work for wages, hire or engage the services of another person
employee; a person working for wages or a salary
employer; a person offering work to other people for a salary or wages
employment; the state of being employed by a company or other people, occupation
enact; to change something (a proposal) into a law
enclosure; 1. an attachment to a letter 2. a closed area
encountered; faced, met accidentally
end plates; flat steel plates attached to each end of the cylinder block adding rigidity to the block and providing a mounting surface for some parts
endorse; to sign one's name on documents, to verify by signing the document (e.g. a B/L)
engine failure; engine breakdown
engine performance; engine operation and functioning with regard to effectiveness
English Channel; the area of sea which separates England from France
ensure; to make sure
entangle; to cause something to become caught in something such as a net or ropes
enter; 1. to go into the port 2. to write remarks in the log book
enterprise; 1. a business unit, a company 2. project
entrance; way into (e.g.) the port
entrance channel; a port canal leading to the port
entrance lock; a lock at the entrance to the canal or port
entry; recording something in the log-book or in the register
environment; surroundings, nature, natural habitat
epilepsy; disorder of the central nervous system of a person
EPIRB; Emergency Position Indicating Radio Beacon
equipment; gear, rigging
equip with; to fit with, furnish with, provide with, rig
equivalent; equal in value, measure and force
erode; to slowly reduce or destroy
error; mistake
erupt; to explode or burst out suddenly
escape; to get away, slip away
estimated time of berthing; expected time of berthing, also: ETB
estimated time of departure; expected time of departure, also: ETD
estuary; the wide part of a river at the place where it joins the sea
ETB; see: estimated time of berthing
ETD; see: estimated time of departure
evacuate; to remove the persons from an endangered area
evaporate; to give off moisture
even keel; bow and stern of the ship on the same level
excessive; too much
exempt; free from obligation e.g. to pay taxes or pilotage fee
exhaust gas; the waste gas from an engine
exhaust gas boiler; a boiler which produces steam when the engine is running
exhaust ventilation; a vent (narrow opening) which sends the fumes and gases out
expansion joint; a joint which connects pipes and allows for a certain degree of movement

expected time of arrival; estimated time of arrival, ETA
expected time of berthing; estimated time of berthing, ETB
expected time of departure; estimated time of departure, ETD
exposure; the act of subjecting someone to an influencing experience or the disclosure of something secret
extinguish; to put out e.g. a fire
extinguisher; a device for putting out fires, usually portable
extremely high frequency; any frequency between 30–300 gigahertz, also: EHF

F

failure; breakdown in operation of mechanism, a default (esp. of a rudder)
fairlead; fixture that ensures a rope/line leading in a desired direction, often used to reduce friction, (Am.) chock
fairway; navigable part of a waterway
fairway speed; mandatory speed in the fairway
fan; a ventilator
fast; 1. made fast, secured 2. quick
fasten; to fix, to attach
fatigue; physical or mental exhaustion, weariness, esp. of metal, engine parts etc.
fault; defect, flaw, error, mistake
faulty; defective, imperfect
feed water; the water that is supplied to the boiler and is converted into steam
feeder; an object that leads to or supplies a larger thing of the same type
feeder barge carrier; a barge carrier that transports barges to a major port
feeder ship; a container vessel that carries containers from a local port to a major (hub) port and vice versa
fender; a piece of timber, rubber, synthetic material, or a bundle of ropes hung over the ship's side to lessen the shock or prevent chafing between the vessel and the pier or another vessel
ferry; see: ferry boat
ferry boat; a vessel for transporting passengers and vehicles across a river, channels or other body of water, also: ferry
fertilizer; (a type of cargo carried by sea) any substance, such as manure or a mixture of nitrates, added to soil or water to increase its productivity
FEU; Forty Equivalent Unit
filter; a device to remove solids from liquids or gases
fin; a horizontal, often adjustable wing appended to the underwater part of the hull for damping the roll of a surface vessel to stabilize it
fine filter; a device for removing secondary, very small impurities from the lube oil, with a replaceable element
fire alarm; a device for giving a warning in the event of fire
fire extinguisher; a portable container usually filled with special chemicals for putting out a fire
fire control plan; the entire system of detecting and combatting fire
fire fighting equipment; fire fighting gear
fire hose; a special heavy-duty hose (flexible tube) for use in fighting destructive fires
fire monitor; a mounting for a nozzle that allows a stream of water to be directed
fire party; a group of fire fighters
fire prevention; practice of measures and regulations preventing the outbreak of fire
fire watch; an inspection of the vessel by a crew member going around at certain intervals to prevent and detect any fires on board mandatory in vessels carrying more than 36 passengers

fire-alarm; a signal warning that a fire has broken out

firm; 1. a company 2. rigid, stiff

first aid; emergency treatment given before regular medical services arrive

first aid outfit; first aid kit

first aid satchel; a rectangular bag usually made of leather or cloth for carrying first aid equipment

first mate; Chief Officer

first watch; the watch from 20.00 to 24.00 hours

fish hydrolysate; fish carcasses

fishing lure; an artificial insect or other small animal which is put on the end of a fishing line to attract fish

fishing vessel; a ship engaged in catching fish

fitting; 1. equipment, furnishings or accessories in a building or onboard 2. an element used for branching, change of direction or closing a pipe

fix; a ship's position at a given time which is determined by the intersection of lines of position representing bearings of the fixed objects identifiable on the chart

fixed pitch propeller; opposite to a controllable pitch propeller, propeller with fixed blades

fixed rate; an established loading rate or discharging rate

flag state; a state having ships registered under its own flag

flame; light rising from a fire or burning gas

flame arrester; see: flame trap

flame trap; a perforated metal cover over an opening or vent to prevent the passage of flame

flammable; likely to burn easily and quickly

flange; a radially projecting collar or rim on an object (e.g. a pipe) for locating or strengthening it for attaching it to a object

flash; a sudden burst of flame, light or heat

flask; a bottle-shaped container with a narrow neck

flaw; a defect, an error

fleet; all ships both naval and commercial, all ships of a company

flexible; able to bend without breaking, elastic

float; to stay on the surface of a liquid

flo-flo; see: float on-float off

float on-float off; a system of loading barges on to the barge carriers

flood; 1. a great overflow of water 2. the rise or flowing in of the tide, rising of the water level

flooding; major uncontrolled flow or penetration of seawater into the vessel

fly a flag; to navigate under the national flag of a country (e.g. the ship was flying the French flag)

flywheel; a heavy wheel attached to the crankshaft, it stores up the energy during the power event and releases it during the remaining events of the operating cycle

foam monitor; a fire fighting equipment with a revolving foam gun installed on a flat deck

foam; chemically produced substance that smothers the flames on a burning liquid

foam extinguisher; a portable container filled with special chemicals for putting out a fire

FOB; Free on board, delivery of goods on board ship free of charge (see INCOTERMS)

fo'c'sle; see: forecastle

foc'sle; see: forecastle

fog; a cloudlike mass of water droplets or ice crystals near the surface of the earth, which reduces visibility, visibility less than 1000 m

fog bank; see: fog patch

fog patch; a stratum or layer of fog as seen from a distance

foggy; thick with fog

foghorn; a deep, loud horn for sounding warning to ships in foggy weather

foil; a very thin sheet of metal

food chain; a series of living things which are connected because each group of things eats the group below it in the series

food web; a system of food

fore; the forward part of a vessel

fore and aft; located along or parallel to a line from the stem to the stern

forecast; 1. to predict e.g. the weather 2. to calculate something in advance

forecastle; a superstructure at the bow of a vessel used as a shelter for stores, machinery or as sailors' quarters

forepeak; the extreme forward part of the interior of the hull, space between the collision bulkhead and the stem plating

forward; towards the bow or front of a vessel

forward breast line; a line led from the front part of the ship to a bollard on the quay to prevent the bow from moving away from the pier

forward draft; see: forward draught

forward draught; the depth the vessel's bow is drawing, also: forward draft

forward spring; a line led from the forward part of the ship to a bollard on the quay to prevent the vessel from moving ahead or astern

foul anchor; an anchor which has its own cable twisted around it or has fouled an obstruction

fouling; the act of micro-organisms settling on objects submerged in water

foul weather; bad weather, heavy weather

foul wind; unfavourable wind

fraction; a part broken off, a portion

fracture; a crack or a break on a surface

frame; 1. part of the hull construction 2. a border or case for enclosing something

freeboard; 1. on a cargo vessel the distance between the uppermost deck considered fully watertight and the official load line 2. that portion of the side of a hull which is above the water

freezing drizzle; slight freezing rain

freezing point; the temperature at which a liquid freezes, e.g. the freezing point of water is 0 degrees C or 32 degrees F

freezing rain; rain which changes from liquid state into ice on cold surfaces

freight; money paid for transporting goods by sea, air or land

freight market; a market for cargoes carried on board ships

freight rate; 1. amount of compensation charged for the carriage of cargo either per tonne or per cubic metre or cubic foot 2. cargo carried on a ship

freight ton; a unit of volume or weight used for charging or measuring freight in shipping. It depends on the type of material being shipped but is often taken as 40 cubic feet, 1 cubic metre, or 1000 kilograms

freighter; a vessel used mainly for carrying cargo, a cargo ship

fresh water generator; a device which distills freshwater from seawater

friction; the force which makes it difficult for objects or gases to slide along each other

frostbite; injury which is caused by the freezing of the skin tissue or body part

frostnip; injury which is caused by the freezing of the top layers of the skin

frozen cargo; refrigerated cargo carried at lower temperatures

fruit carrier; a vessel for the carriage of fruit

fuel; combustible matter such as diesel oil, fuel oil, coal or gas burnt to produce heat or power

fuel consumption; the amount of fuel used per certain units

fuel cost; the cost of fuel

fuel-driven; propelled by using fuel

fuel efficiency; being economic by minimising the difference between fuel input and movement output

fuel injector; a device with a nozzle, or several small nozzles, through which fuel passes at high velocity

fuel monitoring; to watch and check the consumption of fuel

fuel oil; a fraction obtained from petroleum distillation, either as a distillate or a residue, and used in an engine for the generation of power

fuel oil sludge; part of the remaining particulars and water after fuel purification

fuel tank; a hold in a tanker for carrying crude oil and its products

fuel valve; a valve controlling the injection of fuel

Full ahead!; a standard engine order indicating that the engine should operate using the maximum revolutions forward

Full astern!; a standard engine order indicating that the engine should operate in reverse gear at maximum speed

full speed; highest possible speed of a vessel

fume; unpleasant, harmful and toxic gas or smoke emitted from exhaust pipes, produced by fires, chemicals, fuel etc.

function; 1. to operate 2. a kind of activity

G

gale; a very strong wind of 32–63 mph (14–28 m/sec)

gale warning; a National Weather Service warning of sustained winds having speed in the range of 34–47 knots

gallon; a unit for measuring volume

gangway; see: accommodation ladder

gantry crane; a crane having a hoist fitted in a trolley for parallel movement

garbage; waste material, rubbish or unwanted things that are thrown away

gas; a substance having perfect molecular mobility and the property of indefinite expansion as opposed to a solid or a liquid

gas tanker; a tanker designed to carry gas

gear; 1. equipment 2. a section of a shaft having cut teeth of such form, size and spacing that they mesh with teeth in another part to transmit or receive force and motion

gear drive; a driving mechanism consisting only of gears, a gear train

general cargo; cargo packed into boxes, cases, crates, drums or any other kind of packing not in containers

general cargo carrier; a vessel designed to carry general cargo

generator; a machine for converting mechanical power into electricity

give-way vessel; (in COLREGS) the vessel which must keep out of the way of another in a close-quarters situation

global; relating to or affecting the whole world

Global Maritime Distress and Safety System; a system of notifying authorities about sea accidents, also: GMDSS

Global Positioning System; a system of obtaining a position, also: GPS

GMDSS; see: Global Maritime Distress and Safety System

goggles; glasses worn at work to protect eyes

goods; commodities, cargoes

GPS; see: Global Positioning System

grab; a mechanical device for gripping and lifting cargo

grab crane; a crane fitted with a device for gripping and lifting cargo

grain; a small, hard seed such as wheat, corn, rye, rice or millet

grain capacity; total capacity of the hold available for cargo such as grain with an allowance for the volume occupied by frames and beams measured in cubic metres or cubic feet

grating; a fixed frame of bars covering an opening to allow air to pass underneath

green awareness; being conscious about the environment

green water; water environment extending from the outer edge of the brown-water zone past any continental shelves, archipelagos and islands, perhaps a thousand miles from shore

groove; a long, narrow cut in a surface

gross tonnage; measurement of the total internal volume of a vessel including all under deck tonnage and all enclosed spaces above tonnage deck

gross weight; total weight without deductions for tare or waste

grounding; 1. event of running aground while underway 2. see: earthing

gust of wind; a sudden strong blast of wind

gyro compass; an automatic compass with one or more gyroscopes which point to true North

H

habitat; the natural surroundings in which an animal or plant usually lives

Hague rules; the provisions of the International Convention for the Unification of Certain Rules relating to Bills of Lading signed at Brussels on 25th August, 1924 including the amendments by the Protocol signed at Brussels on 23rd February, 1968, if such amendments are compulsorily applicable to the Bill of Lading

Half ahead!; a standard engine order indicating that the engine should operate at half speed forward

Half astern!; a standard engine order indicating that the engine should operate in reverse gear at half speed

hammer; a tool made of a heavy piece of metal having an attached handle and used for breaking things and knocking in nails

handle; 1. to manage, to deal with 2. a part of a thing to be grasped by hand for operating a machine, device or gear

handling; manual or mechanical process by which cargo is moved, carried or transported

hand-operated valve; a valve in a cargo line which can be opened and closed manually

handysize; a dry bulk vessel or product tanker from 15.000–50.000 dwt

harbour (Brit.) harbor (Am.); port, haven

harbour authority; port authority

harbourmaster; see: harbour master

harbour master; an official who supervises operations in a port area (primarily regarding safety of navigation and for keeping records and control of ship's and seafarers certificates) and administers its rules

harbourmaster's office; the headquarters of the harbourmaster's service

Hard-a-port!; a standard wheel order to put the rudder fully over to port

Hard-a-starboard!; a standard wheel order to put the rudder fully over to starboard

harmful; causing harm

hatch; an opening, usually rectangular, in the deck through which cargo can be loaded and unloaded, often synonymous with ship's hold, usually numbered as holds, e.g. *Hatch #3*

hatch coaming; a raised border around an opening in the deck holding hatch covers and designed to prevent water from running below

hatch cover; Mc Gregor or pontoon cover of such an opening in the deck

hatch ladder; a ladder for climbing down the hatch to the tweendeck or hold

haul in; to pull a line or chain (e.g. back on the forecastle), heave in

haven; a safe place for boats, an old name for a harbour or a port

hawse; part of a bow where hawseholes for the anchor cable are located

hawse pipe; the tube leading through the hawsehole to prevent chafe of anchor chain or rope

hazard; a danger

hazardous; dangerous, esp. to the health or safety of human beings

hazardous cargo; cargo which may cause harm to humans, animals or the environment

heading; the horizontal direction of the vessel's bows at a given moment measured in degrees clockwise from north (IMO SMCP 2001)

heat exchanger; a device used either as a heater or a cooler, or both, in internal combustion engines used primarily for cooling: thus commonly called coolers

heave; 1. to raise or lift with effort 2. to throw or cast a line across

heave away; an order to pull on the line around the capstan or winch drum

heave in; to start pulling a line which is slack, remove the slack of the line or chain

heave on; to tighten the line

heave to; 1. to delay arrival (for a certain time, because of early landfall) 2. a manoeuvre or slowing down and turning the ship's head in extremely heavy weather to reduce stress and strain on the ship's hull

heave up anchor; to raise an anchor, lift an anchor

heaving; a movement where the whole ship rises bodily and then sinks into the trough of a wave

heaving line; a thin line with a pendulum to which a mooring line is attached, used for sending the mooring lines on shore

heel; to lean to one side, to list or incline to one side as a result of wind pressure

heeling; listing of the vessel

helm; a wheel installed on the bridge of the ship to turn the rudder

helm switch; a switch to change the steering mode

helmsman; a person who steers the ship, wheelsman, quartermaster

herbicidal; using herbicides, chemicals used to destroy unwanted plants

high pressure; having the pressure above normal

high sea; 1. open (international) waters of an ocean or a sea not included in the territorial waters of any country 2. high waves

high speed craft; a vessel with engines of high rotational speed, usually ferries making 30–40 knots, also: HSC, high speed vessel

high-speed vessel; see: high speed craft

high tide; 1. the tide at its highest level 2. the time of high water

high water; see: high tide

hinged; equipped with joints that enable swinging, as e.g. a rudder or door

hinterland; (in port or transport economics) catchment area, the land behind the coastal region or an inland area supplying goods to the port

hire; 1. to engage the services for the temporary use of a vessel for the set freight 2. the price paid for the temporary use of a vessel and her space in the holds

hog; to bend, to arch in a center

hoist; 1. to raise or lift by mechanical appliances 2. a cable used by helicopters for lifting or lowering a person in a pick-up operation

hold; a compartment on board ship where the cargo is stowed

hook; a curved piece of metal for catching and pulling something or for suspending something

hopper tank; an enclosed space formed as a permanent structure in ships body, self-unloading, for storing ballast water

horizontal; parallel to the plane of the horizon, not vertical

horse power; a unit of power equivalent to 745,7 watts

hose; a flexible tube for conveying water, oil or other liquid substances

HSC; see: high speed craft

huddle position; position in which a group of people in water crowd together as close to each other as possible

hull; the main body of a ship

humid; damp, moist, containing a high amount of water or water vapour

humidity; dampness

hurricane; violent storm with extremely strong winds (of more than 63 nautical miles) which have a circular movement (Beaufort 12)

hydrant; an upright pipe with a spout, nozzle or other outlet for drawing water from the main pipe in the street or ship for fighting fires

hydrocarbon; a chemical combination of hydrogen and carbon, such as in oil or petrol

hydrographic survey; measurement, description and mapping of the surface waters of the earth with special reference to their use for navigation

hydrolysate; a product of a chemical reaction during which a substance is separated into simpler components by coming into contact with water

hypothermia; subnormal body temperature resulting from long exposure to cold

I

IALA; International Association of Lighthouse Authorities

ice; a solid form of water produced by freezing

ice anchor; a large hooklike device for setting in ice to anchor a vessel or to provide a hold for hawser in warping it along ice drag

ice belt; elongated ice field

ice pellet; piece of sleet in a form of small, translucent ice ball

ice warning; a signal warning about the ice in the area

iceberg; an ice mountain, mass of fresh water ice floating on water

icebreaker; a ship specially constructed for breaking navigable passages through ice

ice-field; a large sheet of floating ice, longer than an ice floe

icing; a coating of ice on solid objects, e.g. the mast or superstructure of a ship

ignite; to cause to start combustion

ignition; the process that ignites the fuel in the cylinder of an internal combustion engine, the act of starting to burn or making something (e.g. oil) explode or burn

illness on board; disease on the ship

immediately; without delay

IMO; International Maritime Organization

IMPA; International Maritime Pilot Association

impact; shock, the force of the collision

impeller; a device that spins inside of a centrifugal pump, in order to develop centrifugal force

in ballast; without cargo

in bulk; (cargo) carried loose, not packed like grain, coal, ore

in case of emergency; in case of danger

in situ burning; burning in its original or usual place, instead of being moved to another place

inaccessible; impossible to reach or enter

inbound; inward bound, e.g. inbound ships, ships sailing into the port, channel or fairway

incident; an unforeseen and unexpected event which may have the potential to become an accident, but in which injury to personnel and/or damage to ship remains minor

incinerate; burn rubbish, reduce to ashes

inclined; having a leaning

increase; to (make something) become larger or bigger

indemnify; to compensate for damage or loss sustained, expense incurred

indemnity; compensation for damage or loss sustained
inert gas; gas not reacting chemically when in contact or mixed with other substances
inflammable; flammable, capable to be set on fire easily, combustible
ingenuity; an ability to think of clever new ways of doing something
inject fuel; to put fuel into the engine
injection; 1. a liquid injected into a body for medicinal purposes 2. fuel injection
injury; physical harm or damage done to a person
INMARSAT; International Maritime Satellite Organization
inner; situated within, inside, interior, e.g. inner pilot station
inoperative; not functioning
inshore navigation; coastal traffic, navigation along the coast
inshore traffic zone; a designated area between the landward boundary of a Traffic Separation Scheme and the adjacent coast, also: ITZ
insulate; to cover something with a material or substance in order to stop heat, sound or electricity from escaping or entering
insurance; a system of insuring property or life against damage or loss
internal phone; a device used for communicating on board ship
interval; a period of time between two points of time or events
invertebrate; an animal without a spine
inward vessel; a ship going to or entering the port
investigation; examination (usually in case of accidents, for court purposes), study
invisible; not seen, not visible
isolate; to set apart from others
ITZ; see: inshore traffic zone

J

jetty; a structure built from a shore out into the water for boats or ships (usually oil tankers) to berth, a landing pier, dock
jib; a long beam that stands out from a crane from which the hook hangs down
joint; a place where two things or parts are joined
jurisdiction; the authority of an official organization to make and deal with especially legal decisions

K

keel; a structure along the bottom of a ship or boat from which the whole frame of the ship or boat is built up
keep off; to not go onto an area, or to stop someone or something going onto an area
keep watch; to watch or observe for any danger
knot; a unit of speed equal to 1 nautical mile per hour (used of ship's speed or wind speed)

L

ladder; a framework of wood, metal, rope, etc., on which a person can climb up or down
lagoon; an area of sea water separated from the sea by a reef (a line of rocks and sand)
landing; 1. going on shore 2. discharging goods
lash; to secure with ropes
LASH; see: Lighter Aboard Ship
lashing; securing containers or other cargo with ropes and rods
lashing chain; a chain securing containers or other cargo

latitude; distance north or south from the equator, measured in degrees

launch; 1. to set a boat or ship in the water 2. to put a satellite or rocket into space

lay days; the time allowed to the master of a vessel for loading or unloading

LBP; see: length between perpendiculars

leach; to remove substances from soil by washing it

lead; 1. to guide in a direction 2. the direction of a rope, wire or chain, e.g. how is the cable leading

leak; an unintended hole or crack through which liquid or gas enters or escapes

leakage; a crack or crevice which admits liquids, gases or other elements in or out

leave port; depart from the port, sail out of the port

leaving vessel; a vessel departing from the port

lee tide; a tidal current running in the direction towards which the wind is blowing

leeward; the general direction to which the wind blows in the direction of the leeside, opposite to windward or weather side

leeway; 1. sideways drift of a boat 2. room for free movement withing limits

left-handed screw; a screw rotating in a counterclockwise direction

length; the longest extent of anything as measured from end to end

length between perpendiculars; the length of a hull between the forward and the after perpendicular

length overall; the entire length of a vessel measured from the foremost point of the bow to the aftermost point of the stern

let go; (of an anchor) to drop the anchor, (of a line) to cast off the line, release the line

lethal; able to cause or causing death, extremely dangerous

liability; a state when someone is legally responsible for something

life buoy; a form of a buoyant device for supporting persons fallen into the water or washed overboard

life jacket; (Brit.) a sleeveless jacket of buoyant or inflatable construction for supporting the wearer in deep water

life vest; see: life jacket

lifebelt; a belt-like life preserver

lifeboat; a double-ended ship's boat readily able to rescue persons from a sinking ship

lifeboat station; 1. a place assigned to crew and passengers where they must gather before being ordered into the lifeboats 2. a station on shore where lifeboats are housed

life-float; a ring-shaped float of balsa wood or metal tubing having a grating at the centre for rescuing a number of survivors from a foundered ship

liferaft; an inflatable raft used in an emergency when a ship must be abandoned or when a plane is downed at sea

lift on - lift off; vertical system of loading containers by shore-based (gantry) cranes

lift on - lift off vessel; a ship which is loaded and unloaded by shore-based (gantry) cranes, also: Lo-Lo ship

Lighter Aboard Ship; a barge-carrying vessel, also: LASH

lightering; the process of transferring oil cargo between vessels of largely different sizes

lights switchboard; a panel used for turning on ship lights and illuminate the ship's superstructure and the decks

limited liability; restricted financial responsibility

line; 1. a rope or wire for mooring a ship, cable, cord 2. a long thin mark on the surface 3. electric line or lead 4. pipe 5. shipping line

liner; a vessel sailing on a regular line to a fixed timetable

liquefied natural gas carrier; a ship specially constructed for the carriage of natural gas in a liquid form, also: LNG carrier

liquefied petroleum gas carrier; a ship specially constructed for the carriage of petroleum gas in a liquid form, also: LPG carrier

liquid cargo; a kind of cargo which flows easily and has the same shape as its container

list; 1. inclination of a ship leaning to one side (usually as a result of cargo stowage or shifting) 2. register of crew, passengers, cargo

litter; 1. to spread across an area or place untidily 2. rubbish or waste products, small pieces of rubbish left on the ground in public places

littoral; relating to or near the coast, coastal

LNG carrier; see: liquefied natural gas carrier

LOA; see: length overall

load; to put cargo into holds or tanks of the ship or onto barges

load line; a line painted on the side of a vessel to indicate maximum immersion when loaded

load line mark; Plimsoll mark

loading; putting cargo onto barges or into the holds of a ship

loading arm; see: cargo arm

loading rate; measure indicating the volume of cargo loaded within a given period

lock; an enclosure in a canal with gate at each end

log book; a book in which events connected with the ship are entered. Main logs kept on board are the navigating log and the engine log. In the early days of sailing ships, the ships records were written on thin, flat pieces of wood cut from logs. They were hinged and opened like a book. This record was called the log book.

Lo-Lo ship; see: lift on - lift off vessel

load on – load off; see: lift on - lift off

longitude; distance east or west from the zero meridian on the earth's surface, measured in degrees

longitudinal; running or placed along the length, opposed to transversal

lookout; a crewmember stationed as a visual watch

lowly leftovers; something that has not been used or eaten when the other parts have been

LPG carrier; see: liquefied petroleum gas carrier

lube oil additives; chemicals added to mineral oils to improve existing properties

lubricate; to grease, to cause machinery to move or work easily

lubricating oil; oil which is put on the moving parts of a machine (engine) to make them move more smoothly, also: lubrication oil, lube oil

lug nut; a rounded nut that covers the end of a bolt (as for holding a car wheel in place)

M

magnetic compass; an instrument that indicates direction relative to the earth's magnetic poles

main air compressor; a device which fills main air bottles

main engine; the engine used as the primary propulsion unit

main engine emergency controls; controls used to operate the main engine in emergency situations

maintenance; keeping in good condition by repairs, clearing etc.

make a lee; to protect from the wind and tide by standing on the windward side of e.g. a pilot boat

malfunction; a failure in the proper functioning

mammal; a warm blooded, hairy animal of the class mammalia, which feeds milk to it's young

manganese; a grey-white metallic element, used in the process of making steel

mangrove; a tropical tree, found near water, whose twisted roots grow partly above ground

manhole; an opening in the cover, deck or tank through which a member of the crew can enter inside

manifold; a system of pipes, pumps and valves designed for operating together

manifold flange; a flange to which the shore loading arms or hoses are connected

manifold valve; a valve at the ship and shore interface used to route the cargo to the desired pipeline

manmade; made by humans rather than occurring in nature

manoeuvrability; the act of turning and directing objects

manoeuvrable; easy to direct

manoeuvring; movement in a certain direction

marina; a small port that is used for pleasure craft

marine; related to the sea or sea transport

marine ecosystem; the complex of living organisms in the ocean environment

marine environment; the air, water, and land on Earth, which can be harmed by man's activities

marine VHF Radiotelephone; a telephone for providing general communications in accordance with GMDSS requirements

mariner; a seaman, sailor, seafarer

mark; a seamark or a landmark

mark buoy; a warning buoy

MARPOL; International Convention for the Prevention of Pollution from Ships

mast; a vertical spar for supporting sails, rigging, flags etc.

master; see: master mariner

master mariner; Ship's Captain

master valve; a valve which separates tanks in fore-and-aft direction

Master's Certificate; the certificate of competency for master of a ship (of 3000 GT or more), issued by the national maritime or transport authority and recognized according to IMO STCW Convention 1978/1995

Master's ticket; see: Master's Certificate

mate; a deck officer on board a merchant ship

Mayday; a distress signal, a signal sent by a vessel in distress

Mayday relay; the passing of an emergency message from a vessel in distress by another ship or station

Meet her!; an order given to the helmsman to check the helm, (SMCP) check the swing of the vessel's head in a turn

merchant; a person or organization that buys and sells goods

MERSAR; Merchant Ship Search and Rescue Manual

microbial population; a number of very small living things which form a group i.e. a population

micro-organism; an organism which is microscopic

Midships!; a standard wheel order to put the rudder in the zero position

midship(s); the centre of the vessel

mid-deck tanker; a tanker having an additional deck intended to limit spills if the tanker is damaged, also: mid-height deck tanker

miles per hour; a unit of speed of a vessel

mist; thin fog produced by very small drops of water gathering in the air, visibility between 1000 and 2000 m

misty; foggy

mitigate; to reduce the harmful effects of something, to make something less harmful or bad

mixed general cargo; goods packed in different cases, boxes, bags, barrels etc.

MMSI; (in GMDSS system) Maritime Mobile Service Identity

moisture; water causing a slight wetness or dampness

monitor; to regularly check and watch something (a situation) carefully in order to discover what is happening

moor; to secure a boat by means of ropes or wires made fast to the shore, or to a buoy or anchor

mooring; holding a ship in place by cables or chains or by anchors

mooring berth; a place where a ship can moor

mooring bitts; vertical fittings of steel or iron or wood, a double bollard for mooring

mooring buoy; warping buoy

mooring line; mooring rope or cable

moratorium; a stopping of an activity for an agreed amount of time

motorship; a ship propelled by an engine

m.p.h; see: miles per hour

MRCC; Marine Rescue Co-ordination Centre

m/s; see: motorship

M.T.; Mean Time, Greenwich Mean Time

mud; wet and sticky earth

multi-purpose vessel; a ship which can be used for different purposes

muster list; 1. a list of crew and passengers and their functions in distress or drill 2. a list of all alarms on board ship

muster station; an assembly station, where the crew and passengers gather for purposes of checking

mutation; the way in which genes change and produce permanent differences or a permanent change in an organism, or the changed organism itself

N

nail; to use a nail to repair or build an item

natural disaster; an event caused by nature which results in great harm, damage or death, or serious difficulty

natural resources; useful or valuable things that exist in nature and can be used by people, e.g. oil, trees etc.

nautical chart; a sea map showing the contours of the land and the depths below the sea level

nautical mile; a unit of distance used at sea equal to 6080 feet or 1852 metres

navigable; of a route that can be navigated

navigable waters; water areas that can be navigated

navigating bridge; a place on board ship that houses all the navigation instruments

navigation; art and skill of steering the ship and taking the ship safely from one point (port) to another

navigation light; a coloured source of illumination on a waterborne vessel, used to signal a craft's position, heading, and status

navigation mark; a pilotage aid which identifies the approximate position of a maritime channel, hazard and administrative area to allow boats, ships and seaplanes to navigate safely

navigational aid; a device intended to assist navigators in determining their position or safe course, or to warn them of dangers or obstructions to navigation, e.g. seamarks and landmarks, charts and navigation instruments

Navtex; a form of electronic mail for Maritime Safety Information including the weather reports and weather forecasts

nickname; an informal name, especially given by friends or relatives, usually based on the person's name or character

nitrogen; a tasteless or colourless gas which is largely part of the atmosphere of the Earth, also: NOX

non-point source pollution; the opposite of point source pollution, where discharges occur to a water body at a single location (= man-made contaminants)

not under command; a vessel which through exceptional circumstances is unable to manoeuvre and thus unable to keep out of the way of other ships, also: NUC

Note of Protest; a written declaration by the Master of circumstances beyond his control that might have given rise to suspecting damage to the ship and the cargo, also when in breach of charter party terms (undue delay etc.)

Notices to mariners; an official publication of the hydrographic office of the navy about navigation safety, maintenance of the fairways, lights, buoys etc.

noxious; harmful or poisonous

nozzle; a tube-like device at the end of a pipe, or a hose, by which a stream is directed

NUC; see: not under command

nucleus; the central part of an atom, usually made up of protons and neutrons or the essence of something (e.g. group of people or things which are the most important part of something)

numbness; state of a body part in which the power of feeling or moving is weakened or lost

nut; a small piece of metal with a threaded hole for screwing on to a bolt

O

OBO; see: oil/bulk/ore carrier

obstruction; an object such as a wreck that blocks the fairway or route

ocean; a great body of water that surrounds the land masses on the earth

odds and ends; different elements of different types, usually small and unimportant or of little value

Officer of the Watch; an officer on duty

off station; (of buoys) not in charted position, also: off-station

offshore; away from or at a distance from the coast

offshore structure; a structure which is at a distance from the coast

oil carrier; a tanker, tankship

oil clearance; removal of oil film from the surface of the sea, oil skimming from the surface of the water

oil drilling rig; a large installation drilling for oil at sea

oil exploration; searching for and discovering oil

oil product; product refined from crude oil

oil seep; the slow moving or spreading of oil as it is released from something

oil slick; a layer of oil that is floating over a large area of the surface of the sea, usually because an accident has caused it to escape from a ship or container

oil spill; an amount of oil unintentionally fallen or flowed over from a container

oil spillage; see: oil spill

oil tanker; a ship for the carriage of crude oil and its products

oil terminal; an industrial facility for the storage of crude oil and oil products

oil water separator; a device which separates oil from bilge water

oil/bulk/ore carrier; a vessel for the carriage of oil, ore or other bulk cargoes

oily residues; an oily substance that remains after a chemical process or oily parts that remain after the rest of the substance has gone

on duty; on watch

on even keel; the bow and the stern of the vessel are at the same level

on-scene commander; a person in charge of the rescue operation on the spot, also: OSC

OOW; see: Officer of the Watch

open sea; deep sea

operate; to function, serve, work

operation; a process of working

operational; functioning, ready for use

OPRC; (International Convention on) Oil Pollution Preparedness, Response and Co-operation

ore; natural substance from which metals and non-metallic materials can be extracted

ore and coal carrier; a vessel for the carriage of ore and coal in bulk

ore carrier; a vessel for the carriage of ore

organism; any living system

OS; Ordinary Seaman, ordinary rating

OSC; see: on-scene commander

out of order; not functioning

out-bound; a vessel leaving the port or fairway and going to sea

over; word signalling the end of a turn in an exchange or transmission

overboard; over the ship's side

overhaul; a thorough examination and repair if necessary

overhauling; a thorough examination for good working order

overtake; to come up from behind and pass

overtime; additional working time beyond the usual time

oxygen; a colourless gas present in the air on Earth needed by people, animals and plants to breathe

ozone layer; a layer of air and ozone high above the Earth, which protects the Earth from harmful ultraviolet sunlight

P

P and I; see: Protection and Indemnity clause

pallet; a large metal plate or flat wooden frame for lifting and storing heavy goods

pallet carrier; a vessel for the carriage of palletized cargo

Panama lead; bow fairlead for head rope and mooring ropes

Panamax; the largest vessel which can pass the Panama Canal fully loaded

PAN PAN; an urgency signal used when the safety of a boat or persons is in danger but the danger is not grave and imminent. Man-overboard messages are sent with this signal also.

particle; an extremely small piece of something

party; 1. a group of people 2. a reception

passage; 1. a narrow channel, a canal 2. ship's voyage, transit across the sea or channel

passenger ferry; a ferry boat carrying passengers

passenger liner; a passenger vessel or cruise vessel

passenger list; a list of names of all the passengers on board ship

PCC; Pure Car Carrier

perishable cargo; cargo loaded into refrigerated containers or refrigerated holds and carried in reefer ships, which are specially built for that purpose. Perishable cargo includes meat, fish, bananas, dairy produce and fruit.

pesticide; a chemical substance used to kill harmful insects, small animals, wild plants and other unwanted organisms

petrol carrier; a vessel for the carriage of gasoline

petty officer; a rank between an officer and a rating, being in charge of ratings, e.g. a boatswain or donkeyman

phase-out; gradually stop using something

photosynthesis; the process of plants using sunlight to produce food

pier; a structure built from the shore and into the water to allow boats/ships to berth on either side, jetty, dock

pillar buoy; a buoy with a staff or spar

pilot; a person giving advice and assistance to the ship's bridge team with respect to transiting an area

pilot boat; a small boat taking pilots to and from ships

pilot ladder; a ladder lowered from the ship's side for the pilot to come up on board

pilot station; the place where the services of pilots are obtained

pilotage; the services of qualified navigators with local knowledge to assist in navigation in particular areas

pilotage compulsory; pilotage obligatory, mandatory

pipeline; a system of pipes or channels for supplying something like oil

piracy; an attack and robbery by pirates

piston; a part of an engine that moves up and down the cylinder and thus moves the crankshaft. It consists of a short solid pipe-shaped piece of metal that tightly fits into a cylinder.

piston boss; reinforced area around the piston pin bore

piston pin; a pin that rests in two bored holes in the pistons and passes through the eye of the connecting rod

piston pin bearing; the bearing either in the eye of the connecting in the bored bosses of the piston rod

piston ring; a circular metal spring used to stop gas or liquid (lubricating oil) escaping from between a piston and its cylinder

piston rod; a rod connecting the piston to the crosshead

pitch; 1. the distance that one point on the face of a propeller blade moves in one revolution, angle of propeller blade 2. distance between the centres of successive threads of a bolt or screw

pitching; a movement where the vessel's bow and stern rise and fall with the oncoming waves

pivot; a point or a shaft on which something turns

planet; a celestial body orbiting a star and massive enough to be rounded by its own gravity

plankton; very small plants and animals which float on the surface of the sea and on which other sea animals feed

plate; a flat, smooth piece of metal or other material

pliers; a hand tool for taking out nails and cutting wire. Pliers have two handles which are pressed together.

Plimsoll mark; a line painted on the outside of a ship that shows the depth to which it can safely be allowed to float in the water when carrying a full load of cargo

plot; to draw a position on a chart

plot the course; to draw a course on a chart

plotter; a device for plotting the course and position

plotting chart; a sea map for plotting courses and positions

plug; 1. the piece in a cock that can be turned to regulate the flow of liquid or gas 2. a round piece of rubber that blocks a hole 3. (in electricity) power plug and socket

pointer; a thin piece of metal that moves and points to a number

poisoning; a disturbance to an organism caused by absorption of a harmful substance

poisonous; capable of injuring or killing by a substance, toxic

polling; a movement where the port and starboard sides rise and fall with the waves coming from abeam

pollutant; a substance that is harmful to the environment

pollute; to make the air, water or land dirty or harmful to people, animals and plants, especially with harmful chemicals or other harmful substances

polluter; a person or organization that pollutes, in SMCP: a vessel emitting harmful substances into the air or spilling oil into the sea

pollution; damage caused to water, air, or land by harmful substances or waste

poop; the aft part of the ship towards the stern

poor visibility; visibility from 1000 metres to 2 nautical miles

port; 1. a harbour 2. the left hand side of the ship 3. a hole

port authority; a government or port city office in charge of port administration and development

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port of destination; the harbour at which the cargo is delivered to the consignee

port side; the left hand side of a ship when facing forward

Port the helm!; an order to put the rudder to the left

portable; a characteristic of an object which can be carried and used anywhere, e.g. portable extinguisher, portable radio

portside; the left side of the ship

pose hazards; to be likely to cause damage

position angle; the number of degrees an object is above the horizon

press; to push hard

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R

racon; a radar transponder used to mark maritime navigational hazards

radar; 1. a method used for detecting position and velocity of a distant object 2. an instrument for determining the presence of objects, their range and bearing

radar coverage; an area covered by the radar

radar plot; position obtained by radar

radar range; a ray%016%0028(e)56371/89-7103334.076150264740561503294074108(e)+4.33056(r)12.l

residue; the part that is left after the main part has gone or been taken away, or a substance that remains after a chemical process such as evaporation

respiration; the process by which a living organism takes in oxygen and gives off carbon dioxide

responsiveness; a measure of an entities ability to deal with or avoid situations

restricted area; an area in vessels where, for safety reasons, entry is only permitted for authorised crew members

restricted waters; water areas such as bays, narrow channels and river estuaries, which restrict navigation

restricted visibility; reduced visibility e.g. by fog or snow or rain

reverse; contrary in position, opposite in direction

reversible; capable of being reversed e.g. a coat that can be worn with either side exposed

revolutions; turns around an axis

revolutions per minute; number of turns during 60 seconds, also: r.p.m.

ridge of high pressure; a narrow and elongated area of high pressure

rig; to prepare for use (e.g. the pilot ladder)

roll on – roll off ferry; a train and vehicle ferry

roll on – roll off system; a horizontal system of loading wheeled freight

rolling; ship's movement from side to side

ROPAX ferry; roll on - roll off passenger ferry, passenger and car ferry

rope; a strong thick line of twisted or braided strands of hemp, flax or wire

RoRo vessel; a vessel designed for a specific system of loading and discharging whereby the cargo is driven on and off by means of a ramp

rotate; to turn around a point or along an axis

rough sea; turbulent sea

rough weather; foul weather, heavy weather

route; a way or a course or traveling

routeing; scheduling of an itinerary or route (e.g. weather routeing)

r.p.m.; see: revolutions per minute

rub; (in physiology) firmly move a hand back and forth or with a rotary motion over the skin

rubbish; waste, worthless or unwanted material

rudder; a device at the stern of a ship used for steering

rudder angle indicator; an instrument indicating the angle of the rudder

rudder blade; a flat cutting part of a rudder

run aground; an event when a vessel hits a rock or the bottom of the sea or a waterway

runoff; (surface) the flow of water from rain, snow or some other source over land

rust; red and orange coating that forms on the iron surface when exposed to air

rusty; affected by rust, covered with rust

S

safe; secure, free from harm

safe speed; speed of a vessel allowing the maximum possible time to stop to avoid a collision

safe working load; the maximum permissible load to be put on a deck or on the weakest part of the gear, such as a crane or a derrick or a rope, also: SWL

safety gloves; gloves used at work to protect hands

safety valve; a valve that opens automatically in the event of too high pressure

sag; (of the ship's hull) to bend downward by weight or pressure or to droop at the centre or have excessive sheer because of structural weakness

sagging moment; downward deflection of a hull amidships due to structural weakness

sail; a piece of canvas extended to the wind in such a way as to transmit the force of the wind to rigging fixed on a ship enabling it to move

sail boat; a boat propelled by wind, also: sailing boat

sailing; the skill of directing the course of a ship

sailing craft; a sailing boat or a sailing vessel

sailing vessel; a large ship equipped with sails

salvage; the process of rescuing, refloating, patching or repairing a ship from or in peril

sample; a specimen of something

sanitize; to make something completely clean and free from bacteria

SAR; Search and Rescue

SART; see: Search and Rescue Transponder

satellite aerial; an aerial used by a shipboard positioning system

satellite dish; satellite aerial in the form of a dish or disc

screw propeller; a rotary propelling device for a ship or airplane, consisting of a number of blades that rotate from a central hub

screwdriver; a hand tool used for turning screws, it is a thin metal rod with a handle

sea; 1. salty water that covers the greater part of the earth's surface 2. a large wave

sea bed; sea bottom

sea captain; the master of a sea-going vessel

sea chest; an arrangement with a valve for supplying seawater to engines and pumps and for discharging waste water from the ship to the sea. It is a cast fitting or a built-up structure located below the waterline.

seafarer; a sailor, seaman

seagoing; ocean-going

seagoing tug; a tug designed or fit for going to open sea

seagoing vessel; an ocean-going vessel

seaman; a person skilled in seamanship, rating

seamanlike; typical of a good seaman, acting like a good seaman

seamanship; the skill of operation, navigation and safe maintenance of a ship

seamark; an elevated conspicuous object at sea or on land serving to guide or warn seafarers

seaquake; an underwater earthquake

search; to look for and look through a place in order to find someone missing or lost

search and rescue operation; an action of looking for missing people and pulling them out of the water

Search and Rescue Transponder; an item of safety equipment which gives a clearer indication of the position of the vessel when activated by boosting the signal received by a searching radar, usually carried in pair for larger ships

Search Mission Coordinator; see: on-scene commander

search-and-rescue area; an area where search-and-rescue operation is taking place

searchlight; powerful beam of light in a particular direction or an apparatus producing this light

seaworthiness; vessel's readiness in all respects for a voyage at sea

seaworthy; safe and fit for a voyage at sea

second mate; a deck officer of the merchant vessel next in rank after the first mate, also: second officer

securing; lashing the cargo

SECURITE; a marker word for a safety call, a signal to announce a safety message e.g. "a dangerous rock located in position..."

sedimentary; (of rock) made from sediment left by the action of water, ice or wind

seep; to move or spread slowly out of a hole or through something

seepage; liquid flowing slowly out of or into something through small holes

sensitive; easily influenced, changed or damaged, especially by a physical activity or effect

sepsis; a serious condition where the whole body is in an inflammatory state

set; direction in which a current flows

settlement; an official agreement finishing an argument

sewage; 1. waste substances, especially from human bodies (urine or excrement) or waste water 2. the system of carrying away waste water and human waste from houses and other buildings (here: from vessels)

sewage tank; a receptacle for collecting waste from the sewer pipes

sewer pipe; a large pipe, usually underground, which is used for carrying sewage away from buildings to a place where they can be safely disposed or treated

severe weather conditions; weather conditions which are not favourable for human beings and property

shackle; a standard length (15 fathoms) of an anchor cable

shackle pin; a pin that secures the shackle

shaft; a revolving rod that transmits motion or power, usually used of axial rotation

shellfish; a sea creature living in shells and eaten as food such as lobster or crab

shift; 1. to move from one side to another 2. a person's scheduled period of work

shift to; to replace, to change

shifting; 1. moving the ship along the quay 2. cargo movement inside the hold

ship; 1. to take on board 2. a vessel

ship broker; ship business representative

ship handling; ship manoeuvring

ship in operation; a ship employed in the transportation of cargo or passengers

ship kite; a huge flying device used on ships in order to move forward

ship propulsion; a means of propelling the vessel

ship propulsion turbine; a turbine for propelling the vessel

ship salvage; saving the ship and its cargo from dangers of the sea

ship stabilizer; fin stabilizer reducing the rolling of the ship

ship stores; supplies, material and equipment for the navigation, maintenance and operation of a ship

ship's agent; see: shipping agent

ship's call sign; ship's identification sign in phonetic alphabet

ship's documents; ship's papers presented at all legal inspections of a ship

ship's logbook; the daily record of all events on deck and in the engine room

shipment; 1. cargo to be shipped to a port, cargo shipped on board for onward carriage, freight tendered to a carrier by one consignor at one place at one time for delivery to one consignee at one place on one bill of lading, consignment, lot 2. the act of shipping goods to another port

shipowner; a person who owns ships or a share in a ship, owners can also act as operators of ships

shipper; an individual or a company with cargo to transport, an agent, working on a commission basis, who finds the cargo and books the shipping space or ship and then arranges the loading of the cargo in the port of shipment

shipping; 1. ships taken as a group 2. commercial activity of sending and delivery of goods by sea

shipping agent; a person or firm who transacts all business in a port on behalf of shipowners or charterers, also: ship's agent

shipping company; a company that owns or hires ships for the carriage of goods by sea

shipping documents; documents referring to the cargo carried on board ship (B/L, waybill, C/P, cargo manifest etc.)

shipping lane; a route through the sea which ships regularly sail and which can be defined by markings on a navigational chart, also: sea lane

shipping line; 1. a regular line operated by ships 2. a company providing liner services

shipping note; a note confirming the shipment of cargo on board ship

shipping order; forwarding order, order by the shipping company to a port company to load the cargo on board, shipper's instructions to carrier for forwarding goods, usually the triplicate copy of the bill of lading

shipwreck; the loss or destruction of a ship

shivering; a state in which the body is shaking from cold

shoal; shallow area of water, a sandbank or sand bar exposed above the surface at low tide

shore facility; a facility located on shore used for receiving vessels and transferring cargo to the vessels

shoreline; the edge of a sea, lake or wide river

short circuit; a wrong electrical connection which causes a breakdown in power supply

shortage; lack of something

SI; the international metric system of units

side; portside or starboard side of the ship

side by side; next to one another

signal flag; a flag of the International Code of Signals

Single up!; an order to leave or remain on one/single line on each mooring, as indicated by the Master or Pilot

sink, sank, sunk; (about a ship) to go down, founder

skimmer; a device used to remove something solid from the surface of a liquid

slack; not tight, loose (esp. a mooring line)

slack away; to ease the rope, pay out a rope

slack water; period of time when a body of water is between the tides

sleet; rain combined with snow

sling; a rope, steel rope, chain or net for hoisting cargo and for holding it while being hoisted

slinging; hoisting a cargo lot, handling a cargo lot

slings; a piece of a hoisting yard to which two or four chains (synthetic or natural fibre) are attached

slippery; characteristic of the surface of an object providing minimal or no traction

slop tank; an aft cargo tank in which remains of oil cargo are stored in a tanker

Slow ahead!; a standard engine order indicating that the engine should operate at slow speed forward

Slow astern!; a standard engine order indicating that the engine should operate in reverse gear at slow speed

slow down; to reduce speed

sludge; a soft wet substance that remains when liquid has been removed

SMC; Search Mission Coordinator

smoothness; not feeling resistance when moving along a surface

SMPEP; Shipboard Marine Pollution Emergency Plan

SOLAS; international conventions on Safety of Life at Sea

SOPEP; Shipboard Oil Pollution Emergency Plan

SOS; Save Our Souls, a signal sent out in an emergency

sound; 1. to send a sound signal 2. straits 3. a noise

sound alarm; a device for giving an audible alarm

sound signal; an acoustic signal given in emergency

sounding; 1. measuring the depth of water with a lead and line 2. measuring the level of liquid in a tank 3. giving sounds

spanner; a hand tool made of a thin piece of metal for turning nuts and bolts

spar buoy; a buoy with a spar (a seamark)

spark plug; a piece fitted into a cylinder to ignite the air-fuel mixture

special area; a sea area where for recognized technical reasons in relation to its oceanographical and ecological condition and to the particular characteristic of its traffic the adoption of special mandatory methods for the prevention of sea pollution by oil is required

species; a set of animals or plants in which the members have similar characteristics to each other and can breed with each other

speed made good; speed over the ground

spherical buoy; a seamark in a form of a ball

spill; escape from a container, shed, scatter

spill control gear; a special equipment for fighting accidental oil spills at early stages

spill valve; a relief valve for taking away excess fuel pressure

spillage; 1. an accidental escape of oil 2. an amount that is spilled

spot light; a strong focussed light thrown upon a particular spot

spray; 1. to force a liquid, e.g. dispersants, out of a special container under pressure so that it becomes a cloud-like mass of small liquid drops 2. water or other liquid broken up into minute particles and blown into the air 3. fine particles of seawater spreading over the ship in heavy weather and seas

spring; one of the lines which tie the ship to the pier to prevent forward or aft motion of the ship

spring a leak; to begin to leak suddenly

spring bearing; a bearing located at varying intervals along a propulsion shaft to help keep it in a straight line

sprinkle; to scatter a liquid or powder in drops or particles

sprinkler; a device for sprinkling water to fight fire

stability; the state of being stable, equilibrium

stabilizer; an apparatus that stabilizes something

stand by; be ready to respond and act, be readily available

stand on; maintain the same course and speed

stand-on vessel; (in COLREGS) a ship having the right of way

standing order; Master's orders to the officer of the watch which he or she must comply with

starboard; right hand side of the ship

static electricity; electric charge that has built up on an insulated body, often due to friction

stationary; being permanent, not moving

steady; firmly placed or fixed

Steady as she goes!; an order to the helmsman to keep a vessel steady on its present heading

steady course; fixed course

steam turbine; a device with blades driven by steam

steamer; a vessel propelled by a steam engine

steer; to guide a ship by means of a rudder

steering; directing the course of a vessel

steering gear; a hydraulic device which controls and keeps heading

steering gear pump; a device which helps to move the rudder blade

steering gear room; a room where steering gear is located

sterile gauze; thin, loosely woven fabric made free from living microorganisms and used for bandages and dressings

stern; the after part of a vessel

stern line; a rope going from the aft part of a ship to the buoy or the pier

steward; a man who serves passengers and crew on board ship

stewardess; a female who serves passengers and crew on board ship

stevedorage; charges for stowing and securing the cargo in the hold or on deck

stevedore; a person or company carrying out the stowing of the cargo on board ship

storage; 1. space for storing goods 2. charges for storing goods

storage tank; a tank at an oil terminal used for storing liquid cargo

stores; supplies, stock

storm; winds of 48–55 knots (10 Beaufort Wind Scale)

storm bound; stopped by the storm

storm warning; 1. showing of storm signals 2. a national weather service warning of winds having speed of 48 knots and more

storm wind; winds having speeds between 48 and 55 knots (10 Beaufort Wind Scale)

stow; 1. to pack or store cargo and put it in an intended place in the hold, on deck or on the terminal
2. to pack or put away (cargo, sails and other gear, etc.)

stowage; distribution of cargo in the ship's holds and on deck

stowaway; a person who hides aboard a ship or a plane in order to get free transportation

strainer; a filter

strand; 1. to beach 2. to leave aground or ashore 3. one of the fibres that are twisted together to form a rope

stranded; left aground, left ashore, grounded

stranding; beaching, grounding, voluntary grounding

strap; a narrow strip of flexible material especially leather for fastening and holding things together

strato-cumulus; a cloud characterised by large, dark rounded masses, usually in groups, lines or waves, the individual elements being larger than in altocumulus and at a lower altitude than 8000 feet or 2400 metres

stratus; a cloud characterised by gray horizontal layer with a uniform base, found at a lower altitude than altostratus, usually below 8000 feet or 2400 metres

streak; a long narrow mark or band, e.g. on the sea surface in heavy wind

stream; a body of water flowing in a channel or river

stream current; the main stream or current in the river

streamline; a teardrop line offering the least possible resistance to the air or water

streamline motion; a movement involving the least possible resistance to the air or water strength, power

strengthen; to make or become stronger

stress; pressure, empar

supercargo; a representative of the owner on board ship to look after the cargo and the commercial side of the voyage

superstructure; all the permanent housing above the main deck including the forecastle, the bridge and the poop

supervise; to oversee work, manage

supervisor; superintendent, a person who supervises work

supplies; provisions, stock

supply; to give, to deliver, to provide what is needed or wanted

supply line; a set of pipes (pipeline) for supplying, for instance, water

supply vessel; a vessel bringing supplies of water, fuel and food to other ships

surface; an outer face of something

surface runoff; the flow of water from rain, snow or some other source over land

surge; a strong forward movement of a wave

surge tank; a tank with a mass of water

surging; a movement where the vessel is pushed forward by the waves and seems to move backwards as she falls back into the troughs

surveillance; supervision, a watch kept over a person or a polluter

survey; examination, a general description of a ship's condition

surveying vessel; a ship carrying out hydrographic survey at sea

surveyor; a person who carries out surveys of vessels and their equipment

survival craft; a rescue boat or a life raft

survival time; expectancy to survive under unusual circumstances over a period of time

survivor; a person who survived a disaster

swallow; to pass food or drink down to a stomach

sway; to move gently from side to side, swing to and fro

swaying; a movement where the whole ship moves bodily to port and then to starboard

swell; a long and unbroken wave which occurs in fine weather or is combined with an actual storm, generally due to effect of heavy wind depression at a wider distance

swing; to cause to move to and fro

switch; 1. to turn on or off 2. a knob for turning on or off

switch off; to turn off

switch on; to turn on

switch over; to change from one power source to another, to change the VHF channel

swivel; (of anchor cable) a fastening device that allows the thing fastened to turn around freely in a full circle

SWL; see: safe working load

syringe; a hollow cylindrical piece of equipment which is used for sucking liquid out of, or pushing liquid into something, especially one with a needle which can be put under the skin and used to inject drugs, remove small amounts of blood, etc.

T

take the ullage; to measure the distance from the top of the cargo in the cargo tank to the deck level

tall ship; a square-rigged sailing vessel

tallyman; a person who tallies or counts packages or keeps accounts of cargo handling

tank; a large receptacle or structure for holding liquids or gases, e.g. an oil tank

tank container; a receptacle for the carriage of liquids or gases

tank valve; a valve which controls the flow of the cargo into and out of a cargo tank

tanker; a vessel designed for the carriage of liquid cargo in bulk, also: tankship

tanktop; inner bottom plating

tar; a thick black liquid substance, sticky when hot, used especially for making the surfaces of roads

TBT; tributyltin, sort of anti-fouling paint

temporary anchorage; transitory anchorage

tender; 1. a supply vessel 2. an offer, a bid

tensile strength; ability to withstand loads, refers generally to metals

tension; 1. electrical potential 2. (physics) a force that tends to produce an elongation of a body or structure 3. a strained relationship between people

tension winch; a winch which applies tension to mooring lines to keep them tight

terminal; 1. a place for loading or discharging cargo 2. final, fatal, mortal 3. (electr.) a point at which current enters or leaves an electrical device, such as a battery or a circuit

TEU; see: Twenty Foot Equivalent Unit

thermal; connected with heat

threaten; to be likely to harm or destroy something

tidal; subject to tides

tidal current; horizontal movement of the water as a result of tides, also: tidal stream

tidal range; the difference between high and low water levels

tidal stream; see: tidal current

tide; 1. the periodic rise and fall of the ocean and its inlets, produced by the attraction of the moon and sun, occurring every 12 hours 2. tidal current or stream

tight; fitting closely, firmly fix in a place

tighten; to make tight or become tighter

tiller; a lever used to turn a rudder and steer a ship

timber; lumber, the wood of trees suitable for building

timber battens; small boards or strips of wood

timber carrier; a wood-chip carrier, a vessel designed for the carriage of wood

timber load line; a Plimsoll Mark on the side of the ship for loading timber on deck

time charter; a contract for the hire of a vessel for a certain period of time

time of arrival; the exact time of the ship's arrival in port

time of berthing; the exact time of the ship's making fast to the quay

time of departure; the exact time of leaving the berth

time zone; one of the 24 divisions of the globe approximately coinciding with meridians at successive hours from the observatory at Greenwich, England

tipping; the inclination of the stern while launching a ship

tissue; a group of connected cells in an animal or plant that are similar to each other, have the same purpose and form the stated part of the animal or plant

TM; see: True Motion

tonnage; the capacity of a merchant vessel expressed either in units of weight as deadweight tons, or of volume as gross tons, primarily a space measurement

ton; a unit of weight, a short ton equal to 2000 pounds (907 kg) is used in the USA, a long ton equal of 2240 pounds (1016 kg) is used in Great Britain, also: tonne

top-off; the act as a result of which the cargo tanks are loaded to a required ullage

top-up; the act during which the oil level in a cargo tank is slowly brought up to its final ullage

topmark; a mark placed on the top of seamarks and landmarks

topmark buoy; a seamark surmounted by e.g. a cone, a sphere, a spar

torch; a small electric light powered by batteries

tornado; a very strong and destructive whirlwind

torque; the moment of a force causing rotation

total; complete, entire, including all elements

tourism; the business of providing services such as transport, places to stay or entertainment for people who are on holiday

tow; to pull by a rope or chain, to pull a ship by tugboat
tow boat; a tugboat, tug
towage; 1. towing services 2. charges for towing
towing; hauling, pulling
towing line; a line by which something is pulled or towed
toxic; poisonous
toxin; a poisonous substance
track; 1. to monitor a moving target 2. a path to be followed between one position and another 3. a rail track
tracking; observation of moving targets
tract; an extended area of land
trade; exchange of goods, barter, commerce
trader; a trading vessel or a person engaged in trade
trading vessel; a ship engaged in trade
traffic; movement of ships, planes, vehicles, cargo, people
traffic control; monitoring the movement of ships, planes etc.
traffic control vessel; a vessel carrying out traffic control, usually a Coast Guard vessel
traffic lane; a one-way route which vessels have to comply with within a traffic separation scheme
traffic separation line; a line separating the traffic lanes in which vessels are proceeding in opposite directions
traffic separation scheme; a routing measure aimed at the separation of opposing streams of traffic by appropriate means and by the establishment of traffic lanes
traffic separation zone; 1. a zone or line separating the traffic lanes in which vessels are proceeding in opposite or nearly opposite directions from the adjacent sea area 2. a zone separating traffic lanes designated for particular classes of vessels proceeding in the same direction
trailer; a large van designed to be pulled by a vehicle
transfer; to convey, move from one place to another
transit; passage of vessels through a canal or fairway or across the sea or ocean
transit cargo; cargo passing through one country with destination to another country
transmit; to send, forward, communicate
transmitter; a device for sending electromagnetic waves
transmitter-receiver; a complete set for sending and receiving electromagnetic waves through an antenna
transponder; a radar transceiver that automatically transmits signals upon reception of a designated incoming signal
transshipment; transfer of goods from one vessel to another outside harbours
transverse; lying or placed across
trigger; to make something happen very quickly, especially a series of events
trim; 1. to adjust the balance of a vessel or to maintain an even balance of a vessel by distribution of ballast, cargo, etc. in a fore and aft direction 2. in good order and condition
trim by the head; the ship's bow is deeper in the water than the stern
trim by the stern; the ship's stern is deeper in the water than the bow
trip; a voyage, passage
truck; a vehicle for the carriage of goods
true bearing; a bearing relative to the geographical meridian
true course; a course whose bearing is given relative to the geographical meridian
true motion; real motion
trunk piston; having neither a crosshead nor a piston rod
tube; a long pipe, or cylinder, for housing something
tubeworm; tube-dwelling worm-like invertebrate

tug; 1. to draw, to pull 2. a small powerful boat used for towing ships or pushing barges, also: tugboat
tugmaster; a small truck for distributing ro-ro trailers in a ro-ro vessel
turbine ship; a turbine-propelled vessel
turn; to cause to move around
turn off; to switch off
turn on; to switch on
turn-round of the ship; the time spent by ships in port, the time needed for loading and/or discharge of a ship in the port
tween deck; space between two continuous decks in the ship's hull such as between a shelter deck and a freeboard deck
Twenty Foot Equivalent Unit; a unit of container vessel capacity equal to the capacity of a standard twenty-foot container, also: TEU
typhoon; a violent tropical storm with strong winds which have a circular movement (found in the Indian or West Pacific Ocean)

U

Ukrainian flag; the official ensign of the Ukraine
ULCC; see: Ultra Large Crude Carrier
ullage; an unfilled space in a tank due to evaporation of liquid cargo, quantity represented by the unoccupied space in the top of a tank or compartment
Ultra Large Crude Carrier; a very big tanker above 300.000 dwt, also: ULCC
UMS; Unmanned Machinery Space
unballast; remove the ballast, pump out the ballast
uncharted; not marked on the chart
under the lee; on the leeward side, also: under the wind
under way; a vessel which is not at anchor or made fast to the shore or aground, a vessel moving
underkeel clearance; an allowance for the depth of water under the ship's keel
underwater; below the surface of water
underwrite; to write one's name at the end of a policy accepting maritime insurance to a specific sum in case of losses
underwriter; a person or a company that underwrites policies of insurance, insurance company
unfavourable; not encouraging, approving or pleasing
unitised cargo; cargo transported as a unit on a pallet or in a container
universal time; Greenwich time
unlash; to remove the lashings, unfasten
unlit; dark, not lighted, when the light characteristics of a buoy or a lighthouse are inoperative
unload; to discharge
unmanned bridge; remotely controlled bridge without the physical presence of people, esp. in modern container ships, tankers, bulk-carriers
unmarked; not marked
unreliable; not to be depended on
unscrew; to loosen a screw, unfasten
upper deck; uppermost continuous deck that is capable of being made watertight, freeboard deck
urban; of or in a city or town
urgency signal; a PAN PAN signal to be used to announce an urgency message requiring immediate action
urgent; requiring immediate action
uw; see: underwriter

V

valve; a device for controlling or stopping the flow of a liquid or gas through pipes or tubes

valve body; unmovable, outer part of a valve

vapour; tiny, visible particles of a liquid flowing in the air

variable currents; currents which change their direction

variable pitch propeller; a propeller with a changeable pitch, controllable pitch propeller

variable wind; wind that permanently changes the direction from which it blows

veer; change of wind direction clockwise, opposite of backing

velocity; speed, rate of motion in a given direction, measured in meters per second

ventilation; providing fresh air

ventilation system; a system of providing fresh air in ship's holds

ventilator; a device providing fresh air

venting valve; a valve in a system used primarily to permit air to escape

vertical; upright, perpendicular to the horizon

very good visibility; visibility from 11–27 nautical miles in clear weather (8 visibility scale)

very high frequency; any frequency between 30 and 300 megahertz, also: VHF

very high sea; waves from 7–10 metres (7 Douglas Sea Scale)

Very Large Crude Carrier; a vessel designed for the carriage of liquid cargo in bulk with a deadweight capacity from 150.000 dwt to 300.000 dwt, also: VLCC

vessel; a craft designed for water transportation, also: ship

vessel crossing; a vessel crossing the fairway

vessel inward; a ship heading for the port

vessel leaving; a ship undocking and sailing out

vessel monitoring system; traffic control system

vessel not under command; a ship which through exceptional circumstances (e.g. engine breakdown, propeller failure, blackout) is unable to manoeuvre and thus unable to keep clear of other ships

vessel outward; a ship leaving the port

vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre; (in COLREGS) a vessel restricted by her draft or nature of her work, a hampered ship

Vessel Traffic Services; a system of vessel traffic control designed to improve safety and efficiency of vessel traffic and to protect the environment, also: VTS

VHF; see: very high frequency

vicinity; the immediately surrounding area

victim; someone or something which has been hurt, damaged or killed or has suffered, either because of the actions of someone or something else, or because of illness or chance

viscosity; ability of a fluid to resist a relative movement

visibility; a distance at which a given standard object can be seen and identified with a naked eye

visibility good; from 5 to 11 nautical miles (7 visibility scale)

visibility moderate; from 2 to 5 nautical miles (6 visibility scale)

visibility poor; from 1000 metres to 2 nautical miles (5 visibility scale)

visibility very good; from 11 to 27 nautical miles (8 visibility scale)

visor; a movable section of a bow, usually on ferries

VLCC; see: Very Large Crude Carrier

volatile; capable of being readily vaporized at relatively low temperatures

volcano; a mountain with a large circular hole at the top through which lava (hot liquid rock), gases, steam and dust are or have been forced out

voyage; sea travel

Voyage Data Recorder; a data recording system designed for all vessels required to comply with the IMO's International Convention SOLAS Requirements (IMO Res.A.861(20)) in order to collect data from various sensors on board the vessel

VTs; see: Vessel Traffic Services

VTs station; a station or centre providing services designed to improve safety and efficiency of vessel traffic and to protect the environment

vulnerable; able to be easily physically influenced or harmed

W

walkie-talkie; a hand-held, portable, two-way radio transceiver, more formally known as a handheld transceiver

warning; caution, something that gives notice of caution

warning of gales; storm warning

warping; shifting of a vessel by means of warping winches

warping buoy; a mooring buoy

waste; unwanted matter or material of any type, often that which is left after useful substances or parts have been removed

waste oil; oil that has been used and has become unsuitable for its original purpose due to the presence of impurities or loss of original properties

wastewater; unwanted used water

watch; 1. to keep guard for a period of time, usually four hours on the bridge or in the engine room 2. a timepiece

watchkeeping; attending to the working of a ship for a period of time, usually four hours

watchman; a person who guards a building or a ship at night to protect it from fire or thieves

water ballast; water carried in the side and bottom tanks for stability purposes

water ballast tank; a side or double bottom tank filled with ballast water

water-boat; a vessel supplying ships with fresh water

waterborne; 1. transported by boat 2. floating or moving on water

waterproof; watertight, water resistant, impervious to water

watertight; constructed so tightly as not to leak any water

watertight compartment; part of the hold behind a watertight bulkhead

watertight door; the stern or bow door on a ro-ro vessel

waterway; a narrow area of water, such as a river or canal, which ships or boats can sail along

wave; 1. a swell, surge or rush of water in the sea 2. a radio wave

wave amplitude; the difference between the crest and the trough of a wave

way; 1. a path or course leading from one point to another 2. manner, method

way point; a position a vessel has to pass or at which she has to alter course (and report) according to her voyage plan

wear; gradual change in quality due to constant use

wear and tear; damage and deterioration resulting from ordinary use

weather; the state of the atmosphere with respect to wind, temperature, clouds, moisture, pressure, rain, snow, hail etc.

weather chart; a synoptic map showing the direction of winds and prevailing weather conditions for a given area at a certain time

weather deck; the uppermost continuous deck exposed to the weather

weather forecast; (for shipping) predicted weather conditions for a given sea area

weather report; (for shipping) summary of the weather conditions in an sea area

wedge; a piece of hard material with a V-shaped edge for splitting something

weed; wild plants that grow in an unwanted place

weigh anchor; to heave up the anchor (clear from the seabed), lift

weld; to join pieces of metal by heating them until soft enough to press together

well; a deep hole dug in the ground either to provide a supply of water or where there is a supply of oil or gas

west; a cardinal point of the compass corresponding to the point where the sun sets

wharf; a structure of wood, stone or concrete, built at the shore of a harbour for ships to lie alongside as for loading or unloading

wheel; a circular frame or disc with an axle connecting it to the ship's rudder for steering

wheelhouse; a part of the bridge of the ship where the navigation aids and controls are found

whistle; to make a high-pitched sound

wildlife; animals and plants that live and grow independently of people, usually in natural conditions

willy-willy; a severe cyclone (off the coast of north-western Australia)

winch; 1. to lift or haul by means of a winch 2. a cargo winch

wind; a current of air, sometimes of considerable force, moving generally horizontally from areas of high pressure to areas of low pressure

wind bound; kept from sailing by a wind from a wrong direction

wind current; an air stream in a certain direction

wind direction; a direction from which the wind blows

wind energy; energy created from the wind

wind force; the power of wind measured in knots or m/sec and expressed in degrees of the Beaufort Wind Scale

wind power; power generated by wind forces

wind pressure; pressure of the wind on the ship's sides

windward; towards or facing the wind

wing; the far side area of the hold, one of the far side areas of the navigating bridge

wing tank; the ship's side tank

winter load line; a Plimsoll line marked on the side of a cargo vessel to indicate the depth to which a vessel may be immersed in winter conditions

wire; 1. to send a message 2. a mooring line made of steel wire/rope

wire rope; a rope made of strands of steel wire twisted together

wire sling; a sling made of wire rope

work shifts; to work for a definite period before being replaced

wound; injury

wrap; to cover an object by winding or folding a covering around it

wreck; a vessel which has been destroyed or sunk or abandoned at sea

Y

yacht; a sailing vessel used for private cruising or racing

yard; 1. shipyard 2. a unit of length in English speaking countries equal to 3 feet or 0.91 metre 3. a long spar supported at the centre to which the head of a square sail or lug sail is bent

yawing; a movement where the vessel's bow is pushed first to port and then to starboard

Z

zenith; 1. the point on the celestial sphere vertically above a given position or observer 2. culmination

zenith distance; the angular distance from the zenith of a point on the celestial sphere to the sphere, measured along a great circle that is perpendicular to the horizon, complement of the altitude

zero emission; no emission

zero visibility; no visibility

zone; an area that is distinguished for some purposes e.g. inshore zone

zone time; standard time as applied at sea reckoned according to the system of time zones

Sources:

The glossary is based on the material of MarEng and MarEng Plus Tools. Besides this, for the formulation of the definitions the following sources have been cited [the headwords concerned are given in square brackets]:

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